20.0 DESIGNER'S NOTES

This game took a bit longer than I intended to bring to your table, but I wanted it to be right. I feel confident that ***FAB volume II*** is indeed ready for action and I feel that it even surpasses the gaming experience we enjoyed in volume I.

The main problem was scale, as this campaign involved far fewer divisions that the battle of the bulge, but the amount of territory was similar. The terrain in Sicily is very rugged, and the battle eventually results in a very narrow front as Messina is approached.

I eventually settled on a scale of one battalion per pip (about half the scale of volume I) and made each division two units and an asset, and also added a divisional integrity rule to effectively encourage players to keep their divisions together.

The next challenge was to effectively divide the island into areas. You will notice more areas that meet at a point in Sicily, this is intentional and an aspect of the difficult terrain.

After a very long time fine-tuning everything to my satisfaction, I took the game for a test drive, and the long effort paid off handsomely in a game that was both fun and gave the correct feel of the campaign.

I have had enormous fun playtesting and fine tuning the game you now hold in your hands. It is my sincere hope it brings you the same fun and excitement for many years to come.

I apologize for the delay in getting volume II into your hands, but I hope you'll agree that it was worth the wait.

Enjoy the game!

—Rick Young

21.0 PLAYER'S NOTES

21.1 AXIS PLAYER

The Axis player needs to hold on, as long as he can, to the airfields, ports, and battlefield objectives. Always be on the lookout for opportunities where the Allies have left a lone block or a critical area exposed to possible counterattack, but be careful you are not placing your counterattacking units in a noose.

As Italian Morale fades, you will have no choice but to shorten your line and back up towards Messina, with an eye on getting your Italians out of the line before they afford the Allies a few easy VPs.

Special Actions are usually best spent buying replacement steps for your German units. As your Italian non-garrison units get reduced to 1-step, pull them off the line and get them off the island. They are not worth anything to you alive, but they are worth a VP each to the Allies if they can hunt them down.

21.2 ALLIED PLAYER

You have a tough job ahead. You must put pressure all along the line and try to stretch the Axis front to the breaking point.

The Luftwaffe will be quite annoying in cancelling your own airpower until you start securing the airfields.

Make use of your flanking invasions, they will interdict movement and cut retreat paths, forcing the Axis to deal with them rather than strengthening his front.

You have a lot of assets that can negate enemy field works (rangers, commandos, naval support, and engineers), use one whenever possible as enemy field works will otherwise slow you down too much.

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22.0 SCENARIOS

22.1 INTRODUCTORY SCENARIO: SUNRISE BRIDGE

22.11 Overview
Use this short scenario to introduce yourself to the rules. The goal is simple — seize and control the special VP areas marked right on the small map.

22.12 Scenario Length
Play Game Turns 1-4 only.

22.13 Area of Play
- Use the Sunrise Bridge map sheet included in the game. Only the areas on this map sheet are in play. All land areas start Axis-controlled.

- Use the Scenario Forces sheet included in the game. It contains the complete listing of forces (units, assets and events) at start and subsequent turns.

- Use the Scenario Information sheet included in the game. It contains the necessary holding boxes, time track and asset draws for the scenario.

- Place the Scenario Forces sheet and Scenario Information sheet next to the Sunrise Bridge map sheet for both players to use. The main map is not needed to play.

22.14 Deployment at Start
Reference the Scenario Forces sheet for the units deployed at start on the map (Axis) or arriving during the Reinforcement Phase (Allied)

- *Axis Deployment of Regular Units*—First the Axis player deploys German and Italian units with a starting area number in those locations at full strength.

- *Axis Deployment of Coastal Garrisons*—Then the Axis player deploys the ten Italian Coastal Garrisons (units with an S*) as follows: all these units are shuffled face-down and placed, one per area, on the Sunrise Bridge map sheet in areas 1-7, 13, 14 and 26.

- *Axis Fortification*—Finally the Axis player places a field works marker on each coastal area that (a) is invasion-capable and (b) has at least one Axis unit in the area.

- *Allied Landing*—The Allied player places the five British beachhead markers in the following landing boxes: B1 through B5. Once the deployment of beachhead markers is done, the Allied player places his units onto the beachheads and the Airborne Assault holding box (14.24), which completes the Reinforcement Phase of Game Turn 1.

22.15 Reinforcements
Reference the Scenario Forces sheet for the arriving units, assets and events for both sides. All units arrive at full strength.

22.16 Special Scenario Rules
All Series and Exclusive rules are in effect unless modified by this scenario.

- British forces are constrained to land and operate in Zone B (14.3 & 14.4) unless specifically released by use of special action (14.61) to enter into areas in Zone A (areas 7, 10, 11, 17, 16 and 25).

- Neither player may voluntarily exit units off the map, with the exception of Allied Sea Retreat (14.28); the Scenario Information sheet contains the At Sea holding box for Sea Retreat. Otherwise, units forced off the map for any reason are considered eliminated.

- The requirements and restrictions for Italian Untried Units are in effect (15.3) including the avoidance of a movement congestion penalty (14.42).

- Fading Italian Morale (17.21) as triggered by the conditional assets (16.4) and events (16.5) is not used.

- The Axis supply source rule (14.91) is modified: a unit is in supply if it can trace a supply path into one of the following friendly-controlled areas: areas 16, 17, 25 or 26. The Allied supply source rule (14.92) is unchanged.

22.17 Victory
Victory is determined at the end of Turn 4 by awarding VP for control of the following areas:

- 1 VP for control of Areas 6, 7 and 10 through 17

- 2 VP for control of Areas 5 and 16

- 3 VP for control of Area 25

- 4 VP for control of Catania (area 26)

These values are included on the Sunrise Bridge map sheet. Elimination of large units does not apply in this scenario. After the VP for area control is calculated for both players, the difference between the two values is calculated. The player with positive net VP is the winner, otherwise the game is a draw.

22.18 Historical Outcome
The British 8th Army faced unexpected difficulty in pushing up the Sicilian coast towards Mount Etna, a naturally impressive and forbidding defensive feature used to great advantage by the Italian 6th Army.

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22.2 THE TOURNAMENT SCENARIO

22.21 Overview

This is the standard scenario, representing the period from the landings on July 10, 1943 through July 19, 1943. Playing this game to completion should take experienced players about three hours. The Allied player must press the attack as strongly as possible, including the achievement of one or more breakouts and/or encirclements of the Axis positions.

22.22 Scenario Length

Play 5 Game Turns unless a Sudden Death Victory is achieved.

22.23 Area of Play

The entire map is used. All land areas of Sicily are Axis-controlled.

22.24 Deployment at Start

- *Units, Assets and Events at Start*—All scheduled units will be deployed (Axis) or arrive (Allied) at full strength. All scheduled assets and events are placed in the Available Box but note the Turn 1 Sequence Exception (22.27). See the At Start reference cards for both players.

- *Axis Deployment of Regular Units*—First the Axis player deploys German and Italian units with a starting area number in those locations at full strength.

- *Axis Deployment of Italian Coastal Garrisons*—Then the Axis player deploys Italian Coastal Garrisons (units with an **S***) as follows: all these units are shuffled face-down and placed, one per area, anywhere in Sicily that the Axis Player desires, including areas that already contain a tried unit, but not areas that already contain two tried units.

- *Axis Fortification*—Finally the Axis player places a field works marker on each coastal area that (a) is invasion-capable and (b) has at least one Axis unit in the area.

- *Allied Invasion Planning*—Now the Allied player examines the Axis setup and may freely choose one of the following two invasion choices: (a) the **Historical Landing Plan** (22.25) or (b) the **Alternate Landing Plan** (22.26).

- *Allied Landing*—Once the deployment of beachhead markers is done (according to the selected landing plan), the Allied player places his invasion units (with an **Inv**) onto the beachheads and the Airborne Assault holding box (14.24), which completes the setup.

22.25 The Historical Landing Plan

- *British Deployment*—The Allied player chooses any five consecutive landing boxes in **zone B** and places the 5 British beachhead markers in them. British units may only operate in zone B unless released from boundary restrictions (allowing them to also operate in zones A & C).

- *American Deployment*—The Allied player places the 4 American beachhead markers in the landing boxes for **zone A**. American units may only operate in zones A & C unless released from boundary restrictions (allowing them to also operate in zone D).

22.26 The Alternate Landing Plan

- *British Deployment*—The Allied player chooses any five consecutive landing boxes in and across **zones A and/or B** and places the 5 British beachhead markers in them. British units may only operate in zones A & B unless released from boundary restrictions (allowing them to also operate in zone C).

- *American Deployment*—The Allied player chooses any four consecutive landing boxes in **zone D** and places the 4 American beachhead markers in them. American units may only operate in zones C&D unless released from boundary restrictions (allowing them to also operate in zone A).

22.27 Special Scenario Rules

- *Rules*—All Series and Exclusive Rules are in effect thus all areas, zones and boundaries are in effect.

- *Turn 1 Sequence Exception*—The scenario begins with the Allied Operational Movement Phase skipping the Allied Admin Phase. All other player turns proceed according to the sequence of play.

- *Reinforcements*—All scheduled units, assets and events listed on the Reinforcement reference cards for both players are available and arrive at full strength.

22.28 Victory

If a Sudden Death Victory was not achieved, then the VPs are calculated per 19.3 and the final tally is compared to the following table:

- **Axis 4 or more VPs** = Axis win

- **Axis 3 or less VPs** = Allied win

22.29 Historical Outcome

After the initial landings, the American landing zones faced ferocious counterattacks by mobile German units, while the British landing zones gained a better footing at first. Over the following nine days, the balance of difficulty switched sides, with the British 8th Army facing a much greater resistance before them, whereas the American 7th Army, ordered to change its direction, advanced rapidly westward.

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22.3 THE CAMPAIGN SCENARIO

22.31 Overview
This is the long game, representing the period from the landings on July 10, 1943 through July 31, 1943. Playing this game to completion should take experienced players four to five hours. This is the scenario that gives the players the maximum scope for exploring various landing plans and defensive deployments.

22.32 Scenario Length
Play all 9 Game Turns unless a Sudden Death Victory is achieved.

22.33 Area of Play
The entire map is used. All land areas of Sicily are Axis-controlled.

22.34 Deployment at Start
This is identical to the Tournament Scenario.

22.35 The Historical Landing Plan
This is identical to the Tournament Scenario.

22.36 The Alternate Landing Plan
This is identical to the Tournament Scenario.

22.37 Special Scenario Rules
- *Rules*—All Series and Exclusive Rules are in effect thus all areas, zones and boundaries are in effect.

- *Turn 1 Sequence Exception*—The scenario begins with the Allied Operational Movement Phase skipping the Allied Admin Phase. All other player turns proceed according to the sequence of play.

- *Reinforcements*—All scheduled units, assets and events listed on the Reinforcement reference cards for both players are available and arrive at full strength.

- **Special Historical Scenario Option**: Players desiring to play a strictly historical version of the campaign use the Tournament Scenario deployment rules (22.24) with the following alterations.

  - Italian Coastal Garrisons (29 in total) are still shuffled face down as described in 22.24, but may only be placed into the following areas: (a) one unit in each of the 23 invasion-capable coastal areas and (b) one unit in coastal areas 26, 28, 29, 30, 48 and 49.

  - The Allied player uses the Historical Landing Plan as described in 22.25 with one additional restriction: the British beachheads must be boxes B1 through B5.

22.38 Victory
If a Sudden Death Victory was not achieved, then the VP's are calculated per 19.3 and the final tally is compared to the following table:

- **4+ VPs** = Operational Victory for the side with the VP's

- **1-3 VPs** = Marginal Victory for the side with the VP's

- **0 VPs** = Draw

22.38 Historical Outcome
By the end of July, it was clear to the combatants that Operation Husky, the largest amphibious invasion ever undertaken, had proven that the Allied partners could effectively conduct a massive combined operation under extreme circumstances (beach landings into difficult mountainous terrain). The pathway via the "underbelly" looked very bright for the foreseeable future, despite missed opportunities and some brilliant defensive maneuvering.

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23.0 EXAMPLES OF PLAY

While these examples are generally organized by the phases in a player turn, the examples typically stand alone – the narrative is not continuous. Some examples use characteristic situations that appear in the game, others use hypothetical situations to better illustrate a group of rules.

Reinforcement & Admin Phases

- Example 1 – Beachhead Selection & Setup
- Example 2 – Draw of Assets & Events
- Example 3 – Air Interdiction & Dogfighting
- Example 4 – Port Damage & Repair
- Example 5 – Army Boundaries

Movement Phases

- Example 6 – Basic Movement
- Example 7 – Restricted Terrain Boundaries
- Example 8 – Bridge Crossing
- Example 9 – Landing
- Example 10 – Fading Italian Morale
- Example 11 – Strategic Movement

Combat Phase

- Example 12 – Basic Combat
- Example 13 – Airborne Assault
- Example 14 – Beach Assault
- Example 15 – Flanking Invasion
- Example 16 – Retreat

Various Other Phases

- Example 17 – Reaction & Breakthrough
- Example 18 – Supply

EXAMPLE 1 — BEACHHEAD SELECTION & SETUP

Overview — We start with beachhead selection because this is fundamental to understanding the challenge of this design. Around the coast of the island of Sicily there are three ranges of landing boxes pointing to land areas, representing the places Allied planners considered for invasion sites. The historic sites (A1 through A4 and B1 through B6) have specific codenames associated with each of the historic landing sites. The sites labeled D1 through D13 do not have codenames but that entire stretch was considered during Allied planning. In this design, the Axis player does not know whether the Allied player will select the historic plan or some alternate plan. His challenge is to face this unknown. The Allied player will have enough intelligence to see generally where the Axis player has deployed and can ponder his options. The attractions for a historic approach or an alternate approach are different. Which will you pick?

A — The players have chosen to play the Campaign Scenario, which allows the Allied player to pick either the Historical Landing Plan or the Alternate Landing Plan. The Allied player chooses the latter, which permits him to land 7th Army (US) forces in any four contiguous landing boxes in Zone D. This represents the selected alternative invasion site for the US forces. Each landing box points to one specific land area on the island of Sicily. During the Reinforcement Phase, the player will place any arriving US units into designated landing boxes (or beachheads). During the Movement Phase, units in beachheads advance (consuming their entire movement point allowance) to the directly connected land areas.

B — There are four port boxes on the map, two subject to British use – Syracuse [P1] and Catania [P2], one subject to US use – Palermo [P3] and one subject to German use – Messina [P4]. They cannot be used as beachheads and so cannot be marked by a beachhead marker. Note that a port is an area that can be entered from either a designated landing box (beachhead) or a port box. Once the port of Palermo [57] is Allied-controlled and uncontested, and the Palermo port box [P3] is fully operational (no damage), then the Allied player can place arriving US reinforcements into the Palermo port box [P3]. During the Movement Phase, units in port boxes not only move directly to the port area but may continue moving.

C — During scenario preparation, after the Allied player selects the landing plan (per scenario instructions), then he places beachhead markers into specific landing boxes in the appropriate zones. There are thirteen landing boxes in Zone D for the Allied player to choose from. In this case, he decides to place markers in landing boxes D2 through D5, giving him direct access to Palermo [57] and adjacent access to Marsala [65]. Once placed, the beachhead markers cannot be moved, although they can be captured (and permanently eliminated) by the Axis player.

D — Once a beachhead marker is placed into a landing box, the beachhead is formally created. It is now ready to support unit arrival. During the Reinforcement Phase, arriving units are

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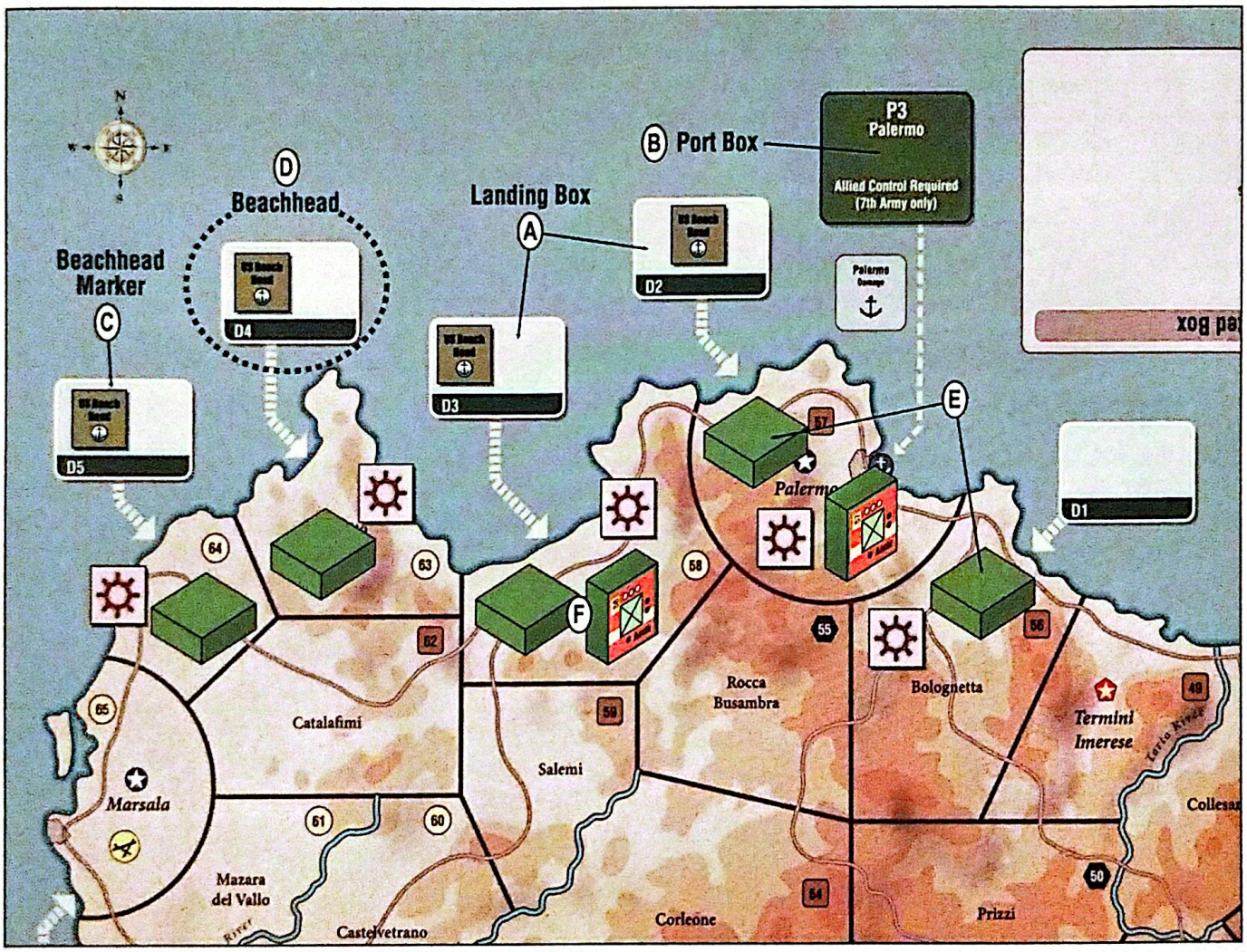
placed into available and appropriate beachheads. During the immediately ensuing Movement Phase, units in beachheads are directly advanced from the landing box to the directly connected land area. This process of arrival and advancement to a land area is identical for port boxes, once the proper conditions for control are in place.

E — As part of his defensive planning, the Axis player has to decide how to place the many weak Italian Coastal Garrison units (with entry notation S*). A handful of them will put up enough resistance to cause some steps of damage to the Allied invader, but neither player knows which will actually do so. Because of this, the Axis player places all of them face down, randomly shuffles them, and then places them (per the scenario directions) into desired areas across the island. If he places them in an invasion-capable area (one that is pointed to by a landing box), he can beef them up with a field works marker at start. Does he place them at the water, in poor terrain, with a field works marker likely to be nullified by Allied Ranger or Naval Support assets or does he place them inland in better terrain, while yielding to his opponent an easy landing?

F — As part of setup, the Axis player also places specific Axis units in predetermined areas (per scenario directions). These units have the area number with yellow highlight as the entry notation. Unlike the coastal garrisons (which represent a practically unknown force), the primary, organized units of the Italian 6th Army were disposed in locations that Allied reconnaissance had mostly determined prior to the invasion. The flexibility of the coastal garrison deployment, therefore, restores to the Axis player more of a chance to induce some doubt in the Allied player's decision as to where to land.



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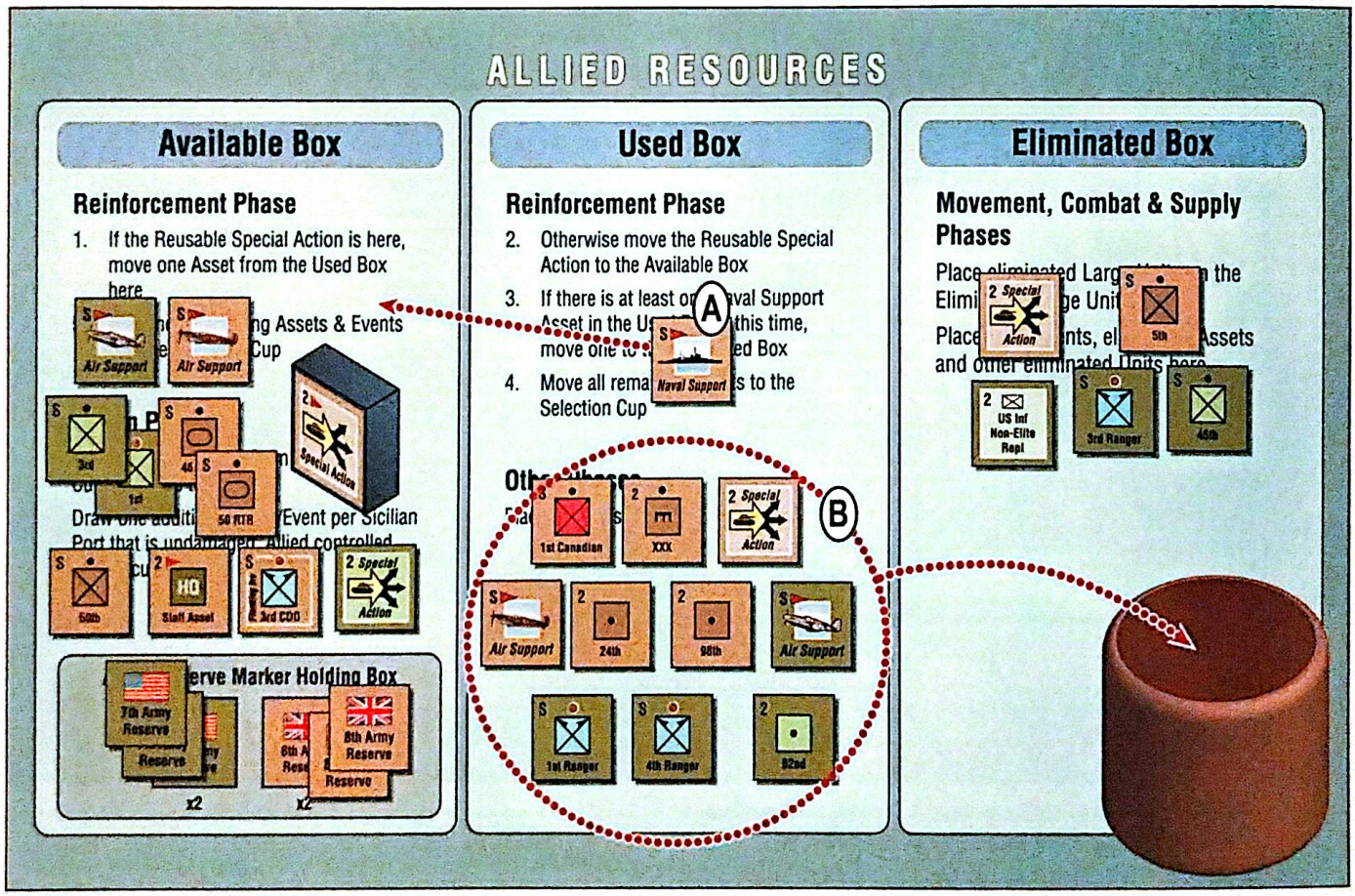
EXAMPLE 2 — DRAW OF ASSETS & EVENTS

Overview — Units, assets and events arrive during the Reinforcement Phase, which happens only at the start of the Game Turn. Both players receive units, assets and events (with a turn of arrival notation, such as **3** for entry on Turn 3). Aside from units already in place at the start of the game, Axis units arrive via the Messina port box [P4]. Allied units must always arrive via beachheads or controlled, undamaged port boxes. Assets and events are placed directly into each player's Selection Cup, which by play convention are opaque cups (coffee cups, paper cups and so on). Although players know what resources are scheduled to arrive (according to plan), they may only immediately receive some of what they expected (requisitions denied or resources lost in transit). At the beginning of the Admin Phase, both players draw a certain number of counters from their own Selection Cups as specified for that turn. For example, on Turn 3, during the Admin Phase of the Allied player turn, the Allied player may draw 11 counters, while the Axis player may draw only 10 counters. Later during the Admin Phase of the Axis player turn, both players may draw 5 counters. Only after the counters are drawn will the players see what assets and events they have actually received.

A — Both players have a Resources section on the map particular to their needs. Certain parts of the sequence of play are listed in the various boxes with a numbered sequence (so the players can perform the necessary steps in order without referring to the player aids). First, the Allied player reviews what he must do in the Reinforcement Phase (using Turn 3 in this example). He sees that he has the Reusable Special Action in the Available Box (step 1 in the Available Box), which allows him to immediately retrieve a used asset from the Used Box. Unless the Allied player saves the Naval Support asset, it must be eliminated (step 3 in the Used Box). He retrieves the Naval Support asset.

B — The listed steps (2 and 3) in the Used Box now no longer apply: the Reusable Action was already in the Available Box and no Naval Support assets are in the Used Box (with one subject to elimination). Next, the Allied player places all the remaining used assets into the Selection Cup (step 4 in the Used Box). Back in the Reinforcement Box, step 5 directs the Allied player to place all the assets and events arriving for the turn (in this case, Turn 3) into the Selection Cup as well.



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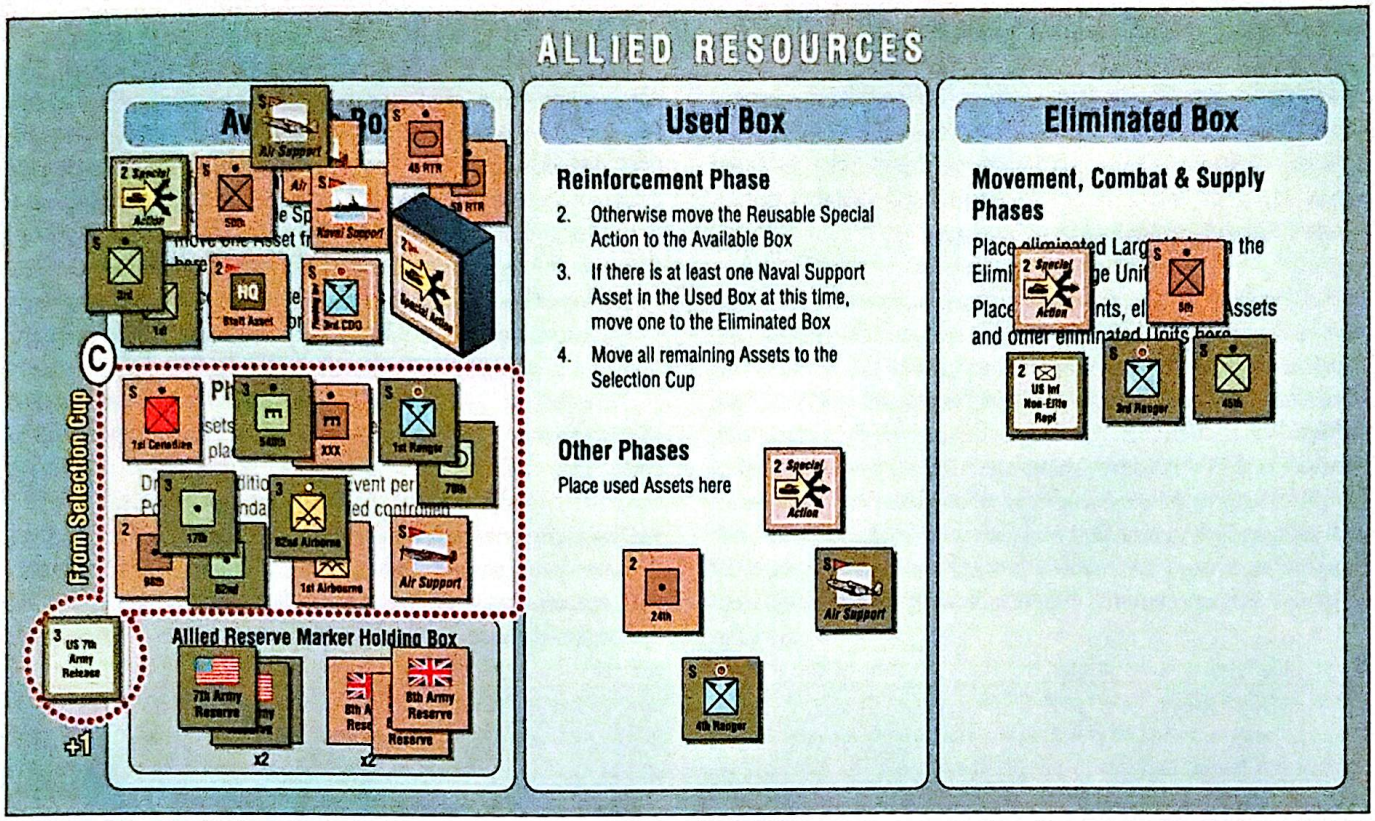

C — After both players have completed what they must do in the Reinforcement Phase, it is now the Admin Phase, starting with the Allied player. He looks at the Available Box and sees he is directed to draw counters from the Selection Cup. According to the calendar on the Turn Track, he may draw 11 counters from the Selection Cup, placing them in the Available Box. In addition, since he controls and occupies the undamaged port of Syracuse [5], he may draw one additional asset, the US 7th Army Release event (giving good fortune for the Allied player). He drew no further Naval Support assets, so it turns out that saving the Naval Support asset was a good choice.

Asset and Event Play — After drawing the scheduled number of assets and events, the Allied player can now play certain assets and events as desired. The Action Matrix and the Event Summary Table are organized by phase to remind players of the choices they can make with their resources. The Asset Capability Matrix provides even more detail about particular effects of asset play, especially decomposing their use in the Combat Phase. Aside from the ever-valuable Reusable Special Action, two excellent choices for the Allied player would be (i) the possible play of the 3rd CDO asset as a Flanking Invasion in Catania [26] or Lentini [14] to maintain maximum disruption at a crucial defensive point for the Axis player and (ii) the definite play of the US 7th Army Release event, giving immediate breathing room to the scope of Allied advance.

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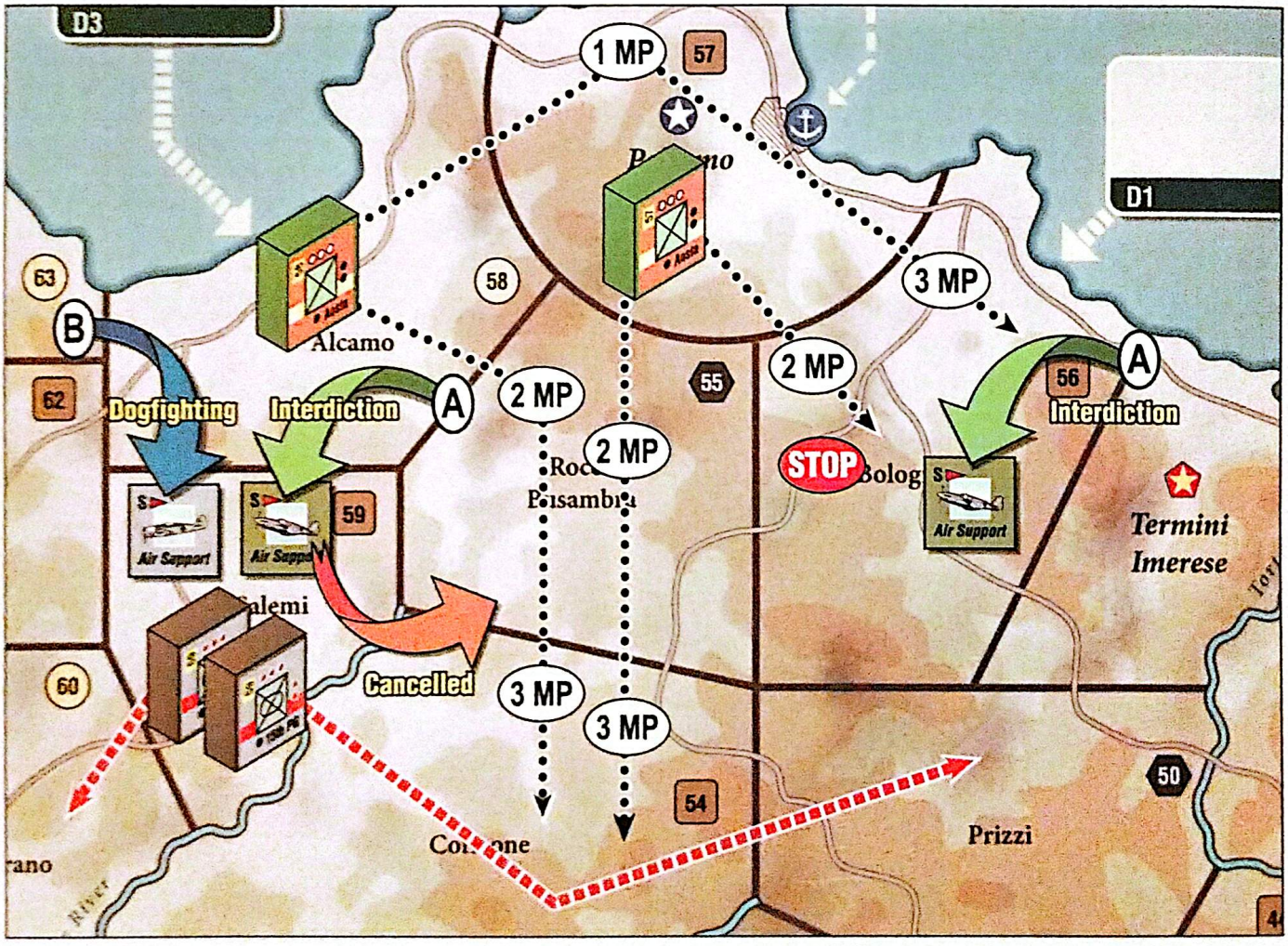
EXAMPLE 3 — AIR INTERDICTION & DOGFIGHTING

Overview — Air Support assets can be played in the Admin Phase (Interdiction mission), Combat Phase (Ground Support mission) or Supply Phase (Air Supply mission) or by the other player (Dogfighting mission) to immediately cancel the attempted mission in each of those phases.

A — During the Axis Player Turn, the Axis player intends to moves his major units on the western end of the island eastwards to respond to the Allied invasion. After the Axis portion of the Admin Phase, the Allied player (during his portion of the Admin Phase) commits Air Support assets to the Interdiction mission to stall the Axis response to Allied progress. He takes two Air Support assets from the Available Box and places one each in Bolognetta [56] and Salemi [59]. Each Allied Air Support asset used for Interdiction will cause any Axis units to pay +1 MP to enter and +1 MP to leave the interdicted area.

B — Although it is no longer the Axis portion of the Admin Phase, either player may commit Air Support assets to the Dogfighting mission, which enables that player to cancel one enemy Air Support mission per asset played. The Axis player realizes that his amount of Air Support is much less than for the Allied player, however, he is not willing to have all his units stalled due to Interdiction. He immediately commits his one available Air Support asset to the Dogfighting mission in Salemi [59], which cancels the Allied Air Interdiction mission. This restores freedom of movement to the units in Salemi [59]. Since he does not cancel the Interdiction mission in Bolognetta [56], that mission succeeds and persists until the Axis Supply Phase, when the asset is removed to the Allied Used Box.

C — In the Axis Movement Phase, the Axis player is faced with a less than ideal situation. Assume in these examples that either moving unit is not in the way of the other unit (to avoid explaining potential congestion penalties). The Italian unit in Palermo [57] cannot get past Bolognetta [56] since it has only 3 MP to expend: 1 MP along the road plus 1 MP for Interdiction and it cannot leave the area because it must spend at least 2 more MP to leave. At best, it can make its way to Corleone [54] via Rocca Busambra [55]. The Italian unit in Alcamo [58] faces the same problem and cannot go farther than either Bolognetta [56] or Corleone [54]. The Axis player decided to protect his more mobile German armor units in Salemi [59]. These units can take the road south to Castelvetrano [60] and thence along the coast to reach either Canicatti [40] or Palma di Montechiaro [41], moving significantly towards the action on the eastern end of the island. Alternatively, they could reach Caltanissetta [45] via legal road movement using Corleone [54], Prizzi [50], Collesano [48] and Castelbuono [46] (since primary roads connecting adjacent areas do not have to be literally connected to each other inside an area).



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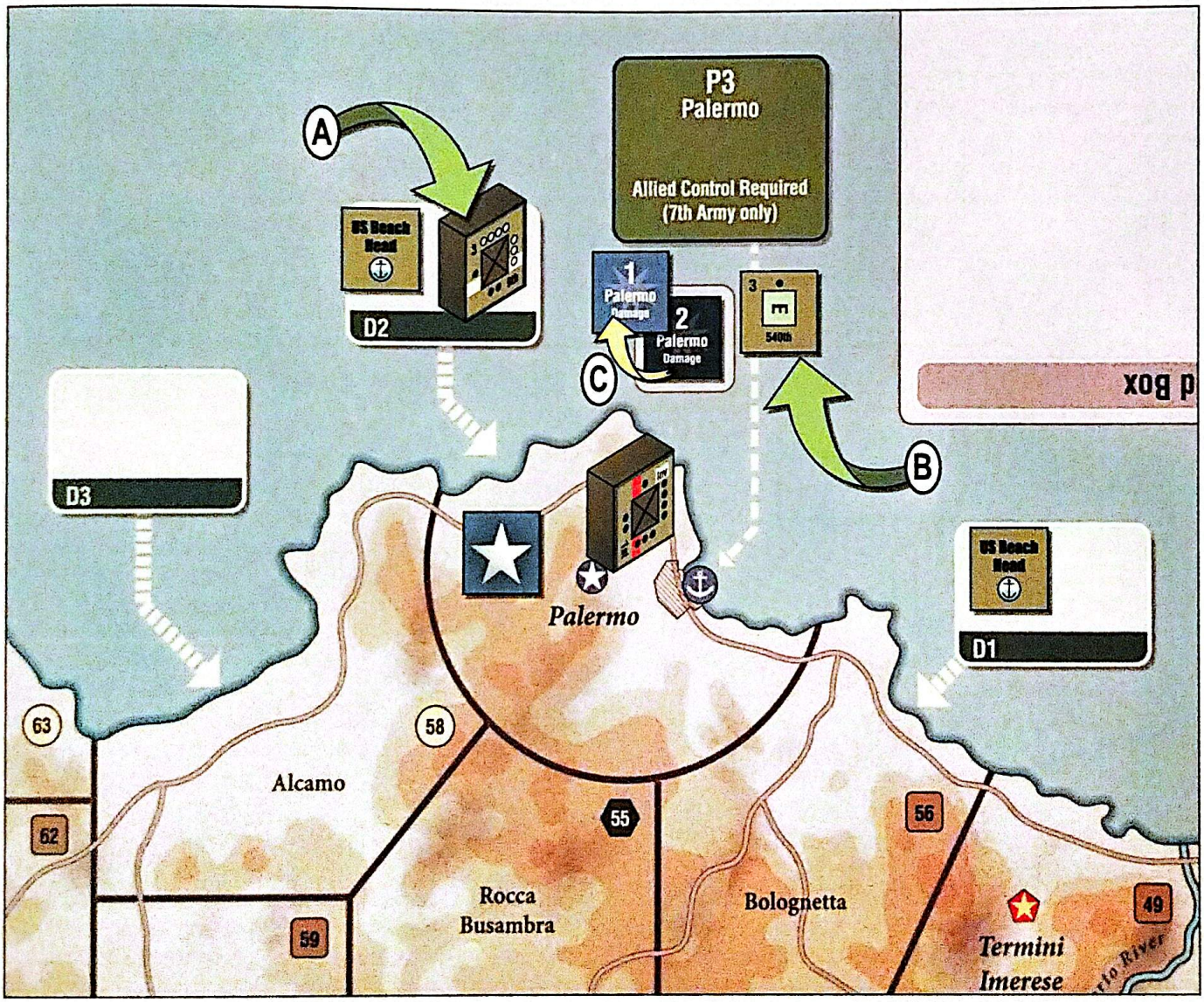
EXAMPLE 4 — PORT DAMAGE & REPAIR

A — During the Reinforcement Phase of Game Turn 3, the Allied player has a US unit arriving, one of the two US 9th Infantry blocks. The battle for Palermo [57] is concluded, with a badly battered 1st Infantry block remaining in the area as a garrison. While the Allied player now controls Palermo [57] because an Allied unit was the last sole occupant of the area, he cannot yet use the Palermo port box [P3] because the port itself (as represented by the port box) is damaged. The consequence for the Allied player is that the sorely needed reinforcement can only be advanced from the beachhead [D2] to Palermo [57] as its sole action during the Movement Phase.

B — During the Allied portion of the Admin Phase, the Allied player decides to use an available Engineer asset to repair the port box one level (from Damage 2 to Damage 1). A necessary condition for the play of this asset is that the port area (Palermo [57] itself) must be friendly-controlled, in supply and (for the Allied player) occupied by a US unit. Since Palermo [57] is friendly-controlled, in supply and occupied by the US 1st Infantry, all three conditions are in place for the Allied player to play the Engineer asset to make the repair of the Palermo port box [P3].

C — The play of the Engineer asset causes the Damage 2 marker to be flipped to its Damage 1 side. The port box [P3] itself continues to remain unusable, and will remain that way unless and until the Allied player plays yet another available Engineer asset during an Admin Phase that will remove the Damage 1 marker. The Axis player may not, during the ensuing Axis portion of the Admin Phase, play an available Engineer asset to cause the damage to go back up to Damage 2. This is because Palermo [57] is not friendly-controlled and in supply (from the Axis perspective). Were the Axis player able to battle back to Palermo [57], solely occupy it and thereby control it, he could then (in an ensuing Admin Phase) damage the port box [P3] once again.



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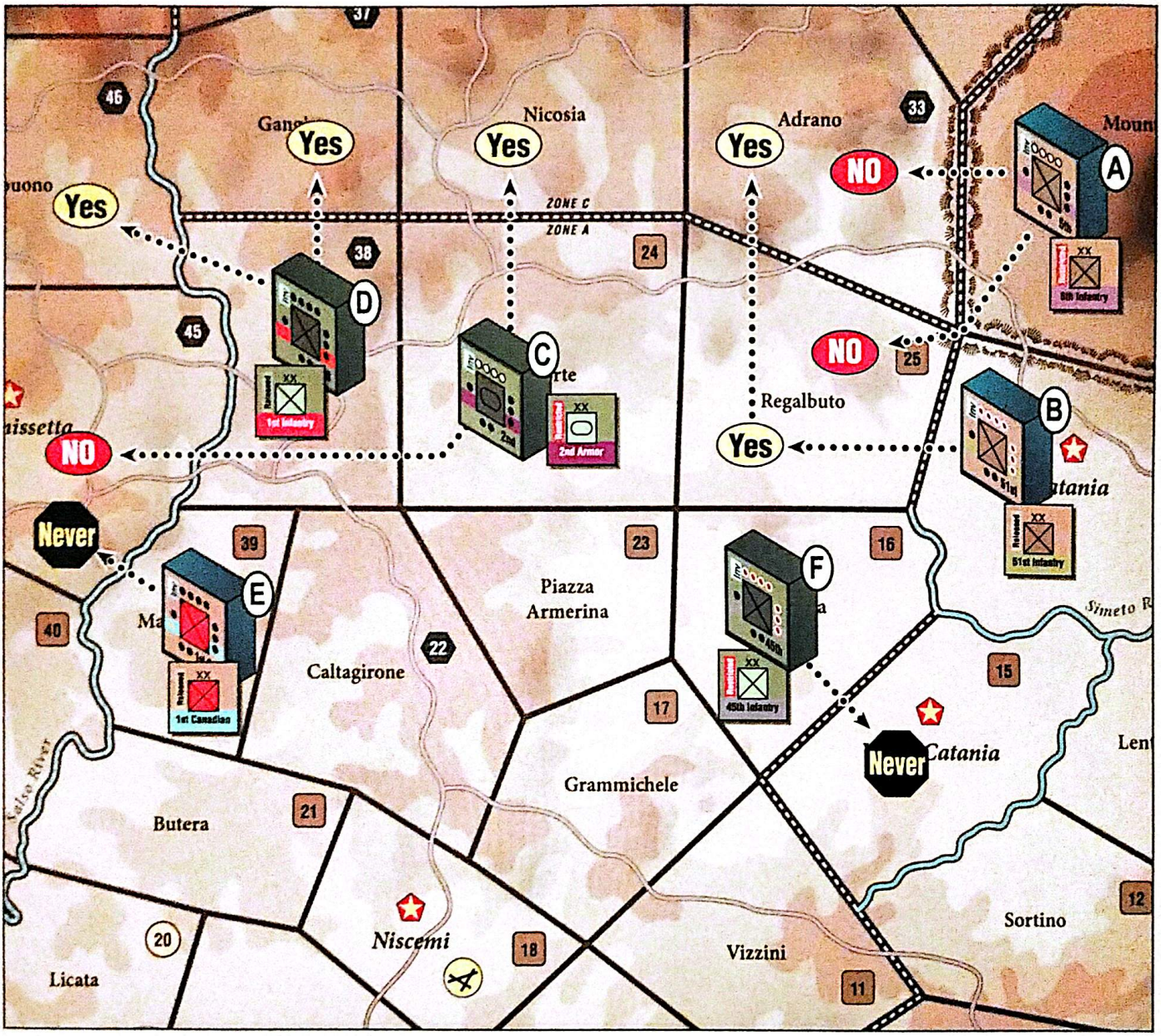
EXAMPLE 5 — ARMY BOUNDARIES

Overview — The Allied army is divided into two higher echelons, the 8th Army (British) and the 7th Army (US), which must operate together within some challenging boundary restrictions. The areas within an army's boundary are collectively referred to by a zone ID. The zones are not strictly fixed, however, since a key to the game focuses on which landing plan the Allied player chooses (based on the Axis disposition). For example, when the Allied player uses the Historical Landing Plan, the British forces must land and operate in Zone B and the US forces must land and operate in Zones A and C (see the map). Zone D represents another operating area, which the forces may move into when formally released (via special actions or events). If the Allied player uses the Alternate Landing Plan, British forces can land and operate in both Zones B & A, whereas the US forces must land in Zone D and may operate in Zones D and C. When released, British forces may additionally operate in Zone C, whereas US forces may additionally operate in Zone A. In all cases, no US force may ever operate in Zone B and no British force may ever operate in Zone D. The scenarios outline the specific conditions depending on the selected landing plan. For clarity, all the components of this example assume the Historical Landing Plan boundary definitions.



FAST ACTION BATTLES: SICILY — Play Book

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A — The British 5th Infantry in Mount Etna [27] is currently operating in Zone B. The divisional release marker in the 8th Army Boundary Restrictions box indicates that the unit is restricted (for clarity, the appropriate divisional release markers are placed on the map next to the designated units). In this state, the unit may not yet move into Adrano [33] in Zone C, nor may it yet move to Regalbuto [25] in Zone A. When released, both moves will become legal.

B — The British 51st Infantry in Catania [26] is currently operating in Zone B. The divisional release marker indicates that the unit is released. In this state, the unit may move to Regalbuto [25] in Zone A and may continue on to Adrano [33] in Zone C.

C — The US 2nd Infantry in Leonforte [24] is currently operating in Zone A. The divisional release marker indicates that the unit is restricted. In this state, the unit may already move into Nicosia [35] in Zone C, but it may not yet move to Caltanissetta [45] in Zone D. When released, the latter move will become legal.

D — The US 1st Infantry in Enna [38] is currently operating in Zone A. The divisional release marker indicates that the unit is released. In this state, the unit may already move to Gangi [37] in Zone C and it may now move to Castelbuono [46] in Zone D.

E — The 1st Canadian Infantry (8th Army) in Mazzarino [39] is currently operating in Zone A. The divisional release marker indicates that the unit is released. In this state, it may operate throughout Zones A, B and C, but it may never voluntarily enter Zone D (the 8th Army is prohibited from operating in that zone).

F — The US 45th Infantry in Ramacca [16] is currently operating in Zone A. The divisional release marker indicates that the unit is restricted. In this state, it may only operate in Zone A. When released, it may then additionally operate in Zones C and D, but it may never voluntarily enter Zone A (the 7th Army is prohibited from operating in that zone).

Release — Release from army boundary restrictions is accomplished in the following ways: (1) The 7th Army can be entirely released by the play of the 7th Army Release event, or individual 7th Army formations can be released via play of a Special Action and (2) The 8th Army can **only** be released formation by formation via play of a Special Action. Note that when you release an 8th Army division, you can simultaneously release one of the three independent Brigades (1st Canadian, 4th Armour, and 231st Infantry).

Retreat — While you may not voluntarily violate an army boundary restriction, it is possible that there is no other way to properly conduct a retreat. In such a case, it depends on whether the unit is forced across a "restricted" army boundary (in which case, it will become released to operate in the eligible zone) or across a "prohibited" army boundary (in which case, it must attempt to return as quickly and directly as possible to an eligible zone).

EXAMPLE 6 — BASIC MOVEMENT

Movement and Boundaries — There are two standard boundary types in the game: open and river. River boundaries always have bridges. When units move across the boundaries, the type of connection they use — road or field — defines the movement cost. When a primary road crosses the boundary of an area into another area — whether the boundary is open or river — that makes the connection a **road** connection. Otherwise, that connection — whether the boundary is open or river — is a **field** connection. Note that the road depictions inside an area do not have to connect with one another.

A — The mechanized German 15th PG unit moves south into Monti Sicani [51], costing 1 MP for the road connection. The unrevealed Italian Untried unit does not impose a penalty on moving Axis units for congestion (since it is Untried, it is unclear whether it will function and to what degree). Then it moves into Aragona [43], costing an additional 2 MP for the field connection, and on to Canicatti [40] for an additional 2 MP for the field connection for a total of 5 MP spent. It cannot enter Caltanissetta [45] to attack the US 9th Infantry unit since it needs two more MP to do it: 1 MP for the road connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area.

B — The mechanized unit moves into Mussomeli [44], costing 3MP (2 MP for the field connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area), and on to Castelbuono [46], costing an additional 1 MP only for the road connection (no congestion penalty applies due to the unrevealed Italian Untried unit). Because the congestion penalty does not apply, the mechanized unit has enough MP to enter Caltanissetta [45] to attack the US unit: 1 MP for the road connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area.

C — The mechanized unit swings northward into Collesano [48], costing 1 MP for the road connection, then on to Castelbuono [46], costing an additional 1 MP only for the road connection (no congestion penalty applies due to the unrevealed Italian Untried unit). Note that primary roads connecting adjacent areas do not have to be literally connected to each other inside an area (a viable road network is assumed in these particular cases). The mechanized unit can not enter Caltanissetta [45] to attack the US unit: 1 MP for the road connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area. With a total of 4 MP spent, this is clearly the fastest way to reach the target area.

D — The motorized Italian Livorno unit moves directly ahead into Mussomeli [44], costing 3 MP (2 MP for the field connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area). It must stop for two reasons: (1) No unit may cross a blown bridge unless it started in the area with the boundary marked by the blown bridge (that is, "directly adjacent"), thus, the unit cannot enter into Caltanissetta [45]; (2) The motorized Italian Livorno division (both blocks) normally has an MP allowance of 3, but this can be increased to 6 if during the entire MP expenditure it neither leaves nor enters an enemy-occupied area; it therefore cannot seek to use this additional movement capability to enter

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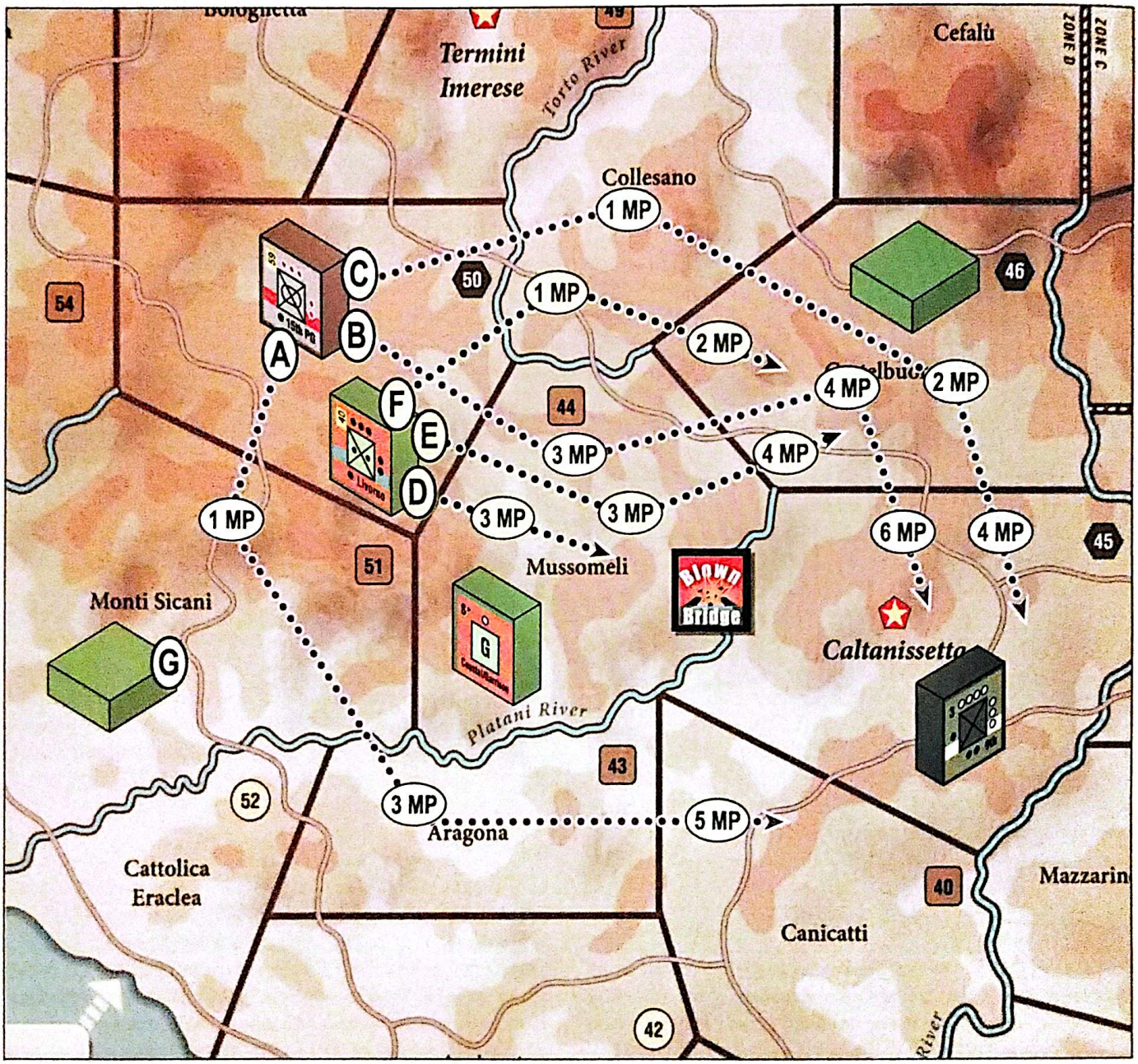
the target area since this would negate the availability of the additional MP.

E — The motorized unit can move into Mussomeli [44], costing 3 MP and continue on to Castelbuono [46], costing an additional 1 MP only, leaving potentially 2 MP to spend (using its motorized capability). However, it is not permitted to enter the enemy-occupied Caltanissetta [45] when using the motorized movement bonus, and thus it must stop. It might continue eastwards down the road, or to unoccupied Enna [38] for its final 2 MP (motorized).

F — The motorized unit can also swing northward into Collesano [48], costing 1 MP for the road connection, then on to Castelbuono [46], costing an additional 1 MP only for the road connection (no congestion penalty applies due to the unrevealed Italian Untried unit). But it still cannot enter Caltanissetta [45] since to enter will require an additional 2 MP (1 MP for the road connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area). It cannot reach the target area whether using its infantry mode (3 MP) or its motorized mode (6 MP).

G — Italian Untried units are severely restricted in terms of what they can do. Only one Untried unit can do anything other than hold position during an Operational Movement Phase. Otherwise, Untried units remain where originally placed unless (i) one of them is selected to "do something" (move, build field works or be placed into reserve) or (ii) Allied units "try" them in combat by entering the area (and they survive).



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EXAMPLE 7 — RESTRICTED TERRAIN BOUNDARIES

Overview — The area of Mount Etna [27] is bounded on all accessible sides by the restricted terrain boundary depiction. Infantry class units must expend their entire movement allowance to cross that boundary. Armor class units are strictly prohibited from crossing the boundary. The exception to these restrictions is that the side that controls the area enables friendly units to use road connections into and out of the area.

A — The armor class German 15th PG in Catania [26] can enter Mount Etna [27] costing 1 MP for the road connection, +1 MP to exit a contested area and +1 MP to enter an occupied area. The unit can also use road connections to pass through the area. It enters Mount Etna [27] for 3 MP, then crosses over to Adrano [33] costing 1 MP for the road connection and stops. It may not enter into either Regalbuto [25] or Randazzo [32] even though it has sufficient MP available since a unit cannot leave a contested area and then enter or create another contested area in the same move.

B — The armor class British 4th Armour in Regalbuto [25] can enter Catania [26] costing 2 MP for the field connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area. It cannot enter Mount Etna [27] since this area is under Axis control. It may participate in an end run around the volcano by entering Adrano [33] costing 1 MP for the road connection, then to Randazzo [32] costing 1 MP for the road connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area, and finally into Novara [30] costing 1 MP for the road connection and +1MP to enter an occupied area for a total of 5 MP.

C — The infantry class British 51st Infantry in Randazzo [32] can enter Mount Aetna [27] despite the move costing more than its movement allowance of 3 MP (All MP to cross the restricted boundary +1 MP to enter an occupied area). It is not prohibited from crossing (infantry class) and therefore it can use Guaranteed Minimum Movement to move to the adjacent area.

D — The armor class German 15th PG in Novara [30] is prohibited from directly entering Mount Etna [27] by crossing the restricted boundary, but it may use the roads to get there, first by entering Taormina [28] costing 1 MP for the road connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area, and then into Mount Etna [27] for 1 MP (road) and +1 MP to enter an occupied area for a total of 4 MP.

E — The armor class German 29th PG in Taormina [28] can enter Mount Etna [27] for 2 MP (1 MP for the road connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area) and may continue through the area and exit on road connections. It could move on to Catania [26] for an additional 2 MP (1 MP for the road connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area) or move out to Adrano [33] for 1 MP (road connection) and end up in Regalbuto [25] to combat the British 4th Armour, costing an additional 2 MP (road connection and entry into occupied area) for a total of 5 MP.

F — The infantry class Italian Napoli Infantry in Mount Aetna [27] is eligible to exit the area using the road connections or the field connections (requiring use of all MP).

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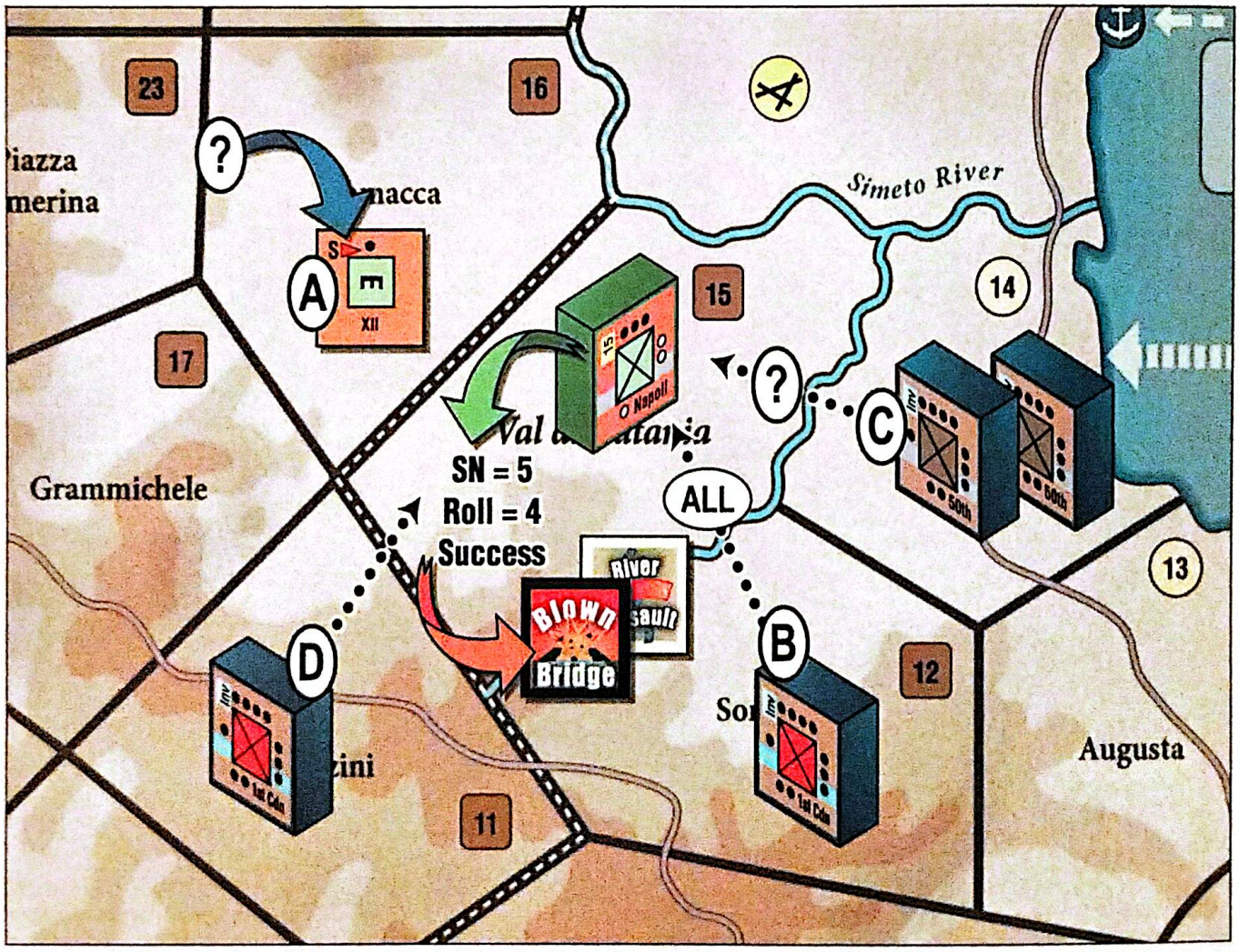
EXAMPLE 8 — BRIDGE CROSSING

A — During the Axis portion of the Admin Phase, the Axis player examined bn the front line situation to decide whether to place an available Engineer in friendly-occupied Val di Catania [15] to automatically blow the bridges (on the Anapo River) to Sortino [12] and Lentini [14]. Neither side has many engineer assets, so perhaps he decided to hold on to the precious engineer asset for use along the Simeto River bordering Catania [26].

B — During the Operational Movement Phase, the Allied player attempts to move the 1st Canadian Infantry from Sortino [12] into Val di Catania [15] across the river boundary (for a possible cost of 2MP for the field connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area). At the instant he declares this attempt, the Axis player, given that this is the first movement attempt across the river boundary, may attempt to blow the bridge. The Success Number (SN) for the attempt is 5 (no modifications allowed) and the Axis player rolls 4 — success! He places the Blown Bridge marker immediately. Now the Allied player must decide whether to continue crossing (at the cost of All MP) or continue moving elsewhere (not yet having formally spent any MP of his allowance of 3 MP). Given how congested the situation is, he will not be able to get this unit into Val di Catania [15] unless he crosses this boundary. Therefore, he moves the unit across for All MP. He now places a River Assault marker into the area, since (at this moment) all units moving into the area (one of them) have crossed a river boundary, one of which must have a blown bridge (which is the case).

C — One of the British 50th Infantry units in Lentini [14] could attempt to cross the Anapo River boundary into Val di Catania [15]. This would be the first attempt to cross that boundary, so the Axis player could try to blow the bridge. Note that even if the attempt to blow the bridge fails, and the infantry unit enters the area across that boundary, the River Assault condition will still apply.

D — If the British 1st Cdn Infantry unit in Sortino [11] moves into Val di Catania [15] instead (for 2 MP for field connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area), the River Assault condition will no longer apply. It can be difficult to crack a defensive position along a river line, so this move from Sortino [11] would actually be the better move for the Allied player. On top of taking away the River Assault, both blocks of the same division (1st Cdn Infantry) would be in the same area and so would receive the Divisional Integrity bonus (plus one die) in combat.



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EXAMPLE 9 — LANDING

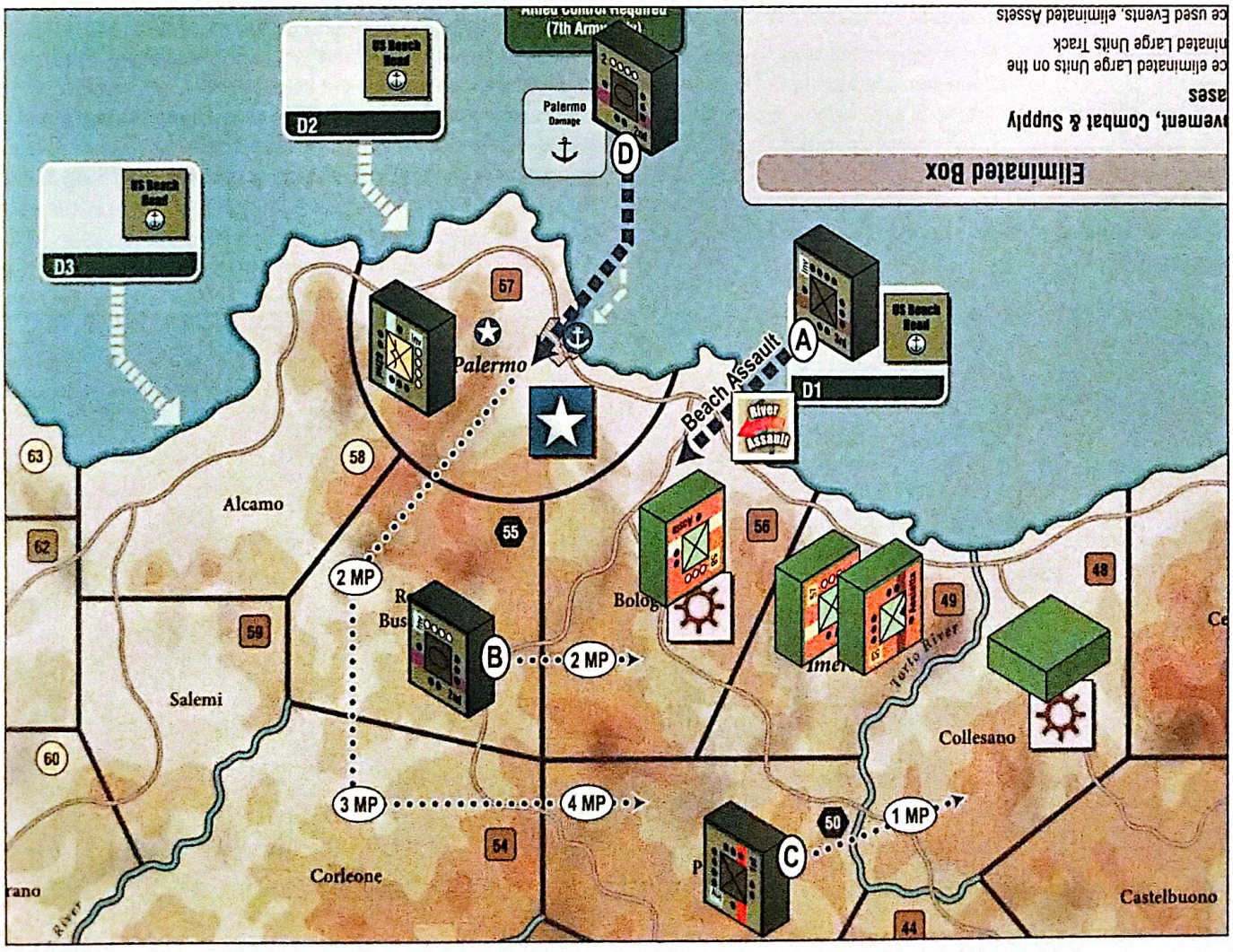
Overview — During the Reinforcement Phase, both players place arriving units in their respective beachheads (Allied player only) or eligible port boxes (both players). These units remain in these staging locations until the owning player's Operational Movement Phase. For the Axis player, the few German units that arrive during the game will remain in the Messina port box [P4] throughout the Allied player turn and will only be eligible to move from that location to Messina and then out to the line during the Axis player's turn. This example highlights various types of landing but the sequences are unlikely to happen in a real game.

A — Invading US units have been placed during the Reinforcement Phase of Game Turn 1 and are now ready to land during the Operational Movement Phase of the Allied player. The 3rd US Infantry staged in the D1 beachhead advances directly to Bolognetta [56] to contest the Italian-held defensive position. The advance from the beachhead to the directly-connected coastal area consumes no movement points. When a unit directly advances (lands) into an enemy-occupied area, creating a newly contested area, the attack is a Beach Assault (and is marked with the generic River Assault marker).

B — During the Operational Movement Phase of Game Turn 2, the US 2nd Armor in Rocca Busambra [55] moves into Bolognetta [56], costing 1 MP for the road connection and +1 MP to enter an occupied area. This move not only put extreme pressure on the Axis position, it clears the way for an encirclement planned by the Allied player.

C — The US 1st Infantry in Prizzi [50] moves into Collesano [48], costing 1 MP for the road connection but the +1 MP penalty for congestion (entry into an occupied area) does not apply since Collesano [48] is only occupied by an Italian Untried unit. The moving US unit must still stop upon entry. The ensuing combat will likely eliminate the as yet Untried Garrison unit, leaving only one path of escape for the defenders in Termini Imerese [49].

D — Finally, the US 2nd Armor in the Palermo port box [P3] must validate that it can advance from the port box: (i) the port box is undamaged (ii) the port area of Palermo [49] is US-controlled and (iii) US-occupied. Therefore, the unit may now advance to Palermo [49], again, without consuming any MP. Since this unit arrived from a port box, it may now continue with a full operational move. It moves from Palermo [49] to Rocca Busambra [55], costing 2 MP for the field connection, then to Corleone [54] for 1 MP (road connection), and then to Prizzi [50] for a final 1 MP (road connection). This move shuts the door on the Italian units in Termini Imerese [49].



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EXAMPLE 10 — FADING ITALIAN MORALE

Overview — This represents a number of interlocking rules elements that get driven through (i) Allied capture of airfields and (ii) Allied capture of ports and/or areas of battlefield importance. Depending on the level of the impact, Italian units of the Axis force — whether starting as Untried units (the coastal garrisons) or starting/becoming Tried units — are effected in movement, combat, and supply. In addition, these effects include the reduction in available Axis air support assets.

Italian Untried Units — The mechanism that immediately affects the Axis player is that of the Italian Untried unit, which impacts all Italian coastal garrisons in all scenarios. These units are set up in each scenario by being placed face down, randomly shuffled and then placed in areas per the scenario instructions. Given that there is only one veteran unit with strength 2, and only four other (green) units with strength 2, the forces themselves are very weak to begin with. Random hidden placement represents the fact that while some of the coastal garrisons performed quite well despite lack of training, equipment and command guidance, it appeared to be a surprise to both sides as to which of these units put up serious resistance. Players will encounter dealing with Untried units especially during the initial stages of the invasion as Allied units land. There are two mechanics — the initial Untried unit morale check and the inability to receive positive SN modifiers — that are used repeatedly.

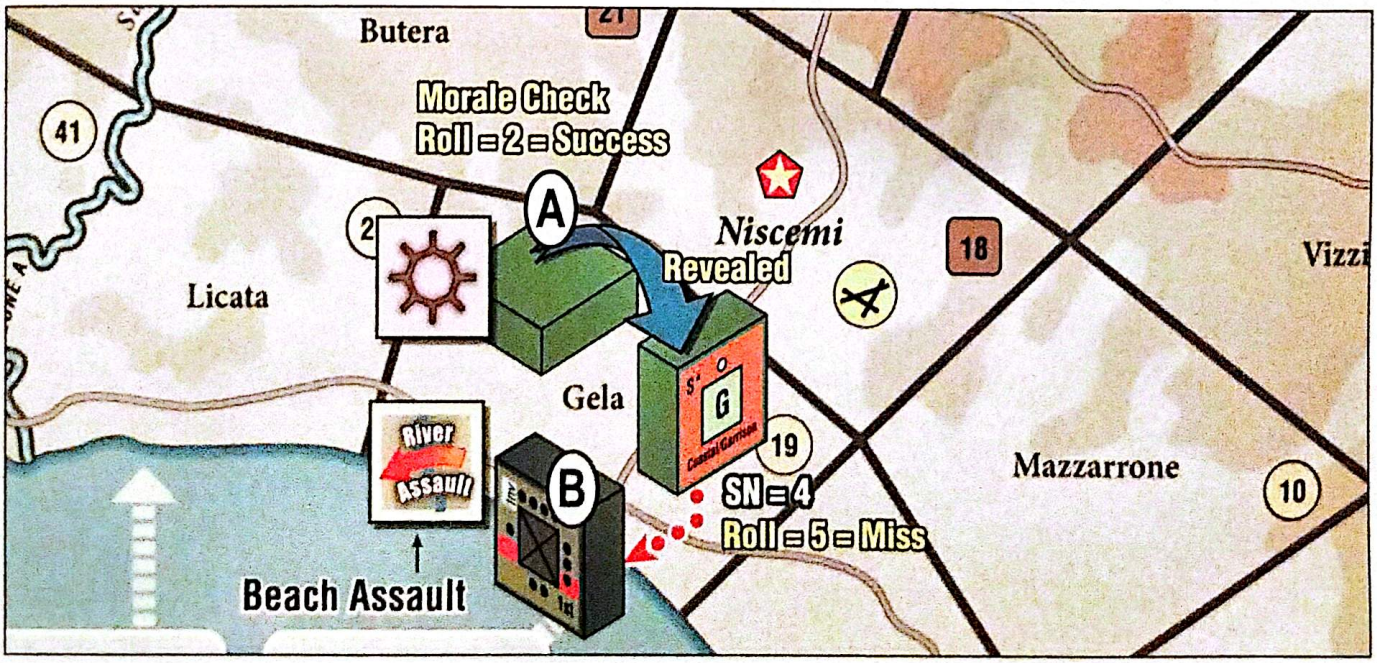
A — After the Allied player selects the area to resolve for combat, just prior to the attacker conducting artillery fire (if artillery assets were committed), any Italian Untried units in the combat are revealed and must undergo a morale check. Regular morale checks in the game use the modifiers in the Morale Table, for troop quality, and whether the unit is disordered, unsupplied or both. The Axis player now conducts the morale check.

- **Coastal Garrison** in Gela [19] has –2 (for green troop quality) but is otherwise good order for a net Success Number (SN) of 5–2=3. This is expressed as "1 try for a 3" — rolls 2 — success!

This first morale check for an Untried unit is very important. The odds are not good for success most of the time, but avoiding becoming disordered immediately at this point increases the chance that the unit can do some damage. After artillery fire, if the unit has still survived, it may conduct ground fire. The key disability for these units is that only the one veteran untried unit can receive positive modifiers during ground fire. The Axis player (as defender) conducts ground fire.

- **Coastal Garrison** in Gela [19] has –1 (for green troop quality vs. veteran) but cannot use the +1 modifier for the targeted unit marked with river assault (since the 1st US infantry unit is conducting a beach assault). Therefore, the unit conducts ground fire with an SN of 5–1=4. This is expressed as "1 try for a 4" — rolls 5 — failure!

B — The Allied player (as attacker) conducts ground fire with the 1st Infantry unit. The following SN apply: –1 (conducting beach assault), +1 (veteran unit firing on green point unit) and –1 (targeted point unit is infantry class protected by field works) for an SN of 5–1=4. If the Allied player had used a Naval Support or Ranger asset to remove the field works just before ground fire, the SN would be 5, and "4 tries for a 5" are very good odds for eliminating the Untried unit outright. If it happens to survive combat, it finally becomes a Tried unit (the Untried unit impacts not longer apply—the unit can operate like any other Axis unit). However, Fading Italian Morale includes a number of systemic disabilities that degrade all the Italian forces as the Allied player makes successful progress.



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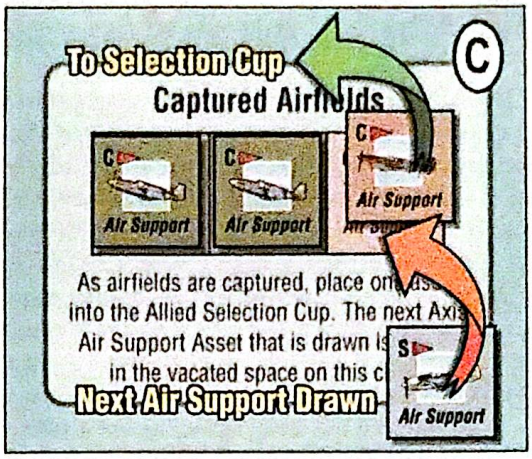
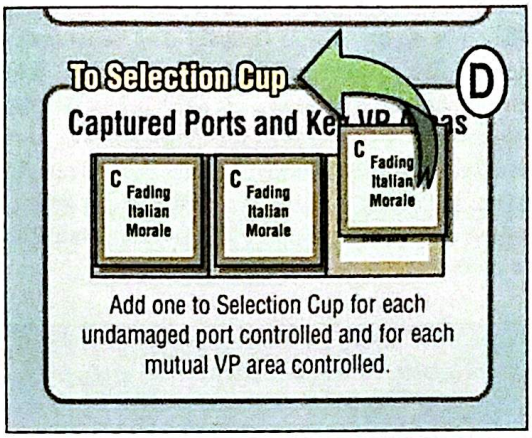
Captured Airfields — For each of the three Sicilian airfields (Catania [26], Niscemi [18] and Marsala [65]) captured by the Allied player, the Allied player gains an Air Support asset (marked with C for Conditional) and the Axis player loses the use of the next Air Support asset drawn during a future Admin Phase.

C — The placement of the conditional Air Support asset into the Allied player's selection cup is immediate (upon capture of the airfield), but does not become available to the Allied player (potentially) until the next Admin Phase. The placement of the Axis Air Support asset into the vacated spot only occurs when the Axis player draws the asset during a future Admin Phase (and he may not draw another asset in its place that turn).

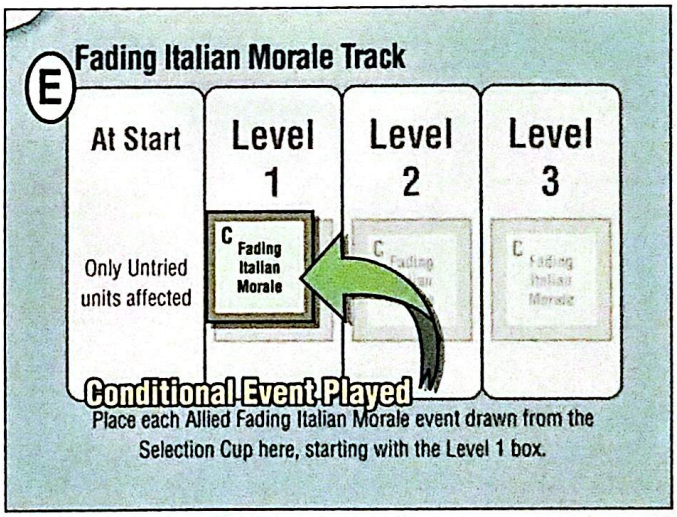


Captured Ports and Key VP Areas — For any three of the three Sicilian ports (Syracuse [5], Catania [26] and Palermo [57]) or any of the five areas of battlefield importance (Catania [26], Val di Catania [15], Niscemi [18], Caltanissetta [45], and Termini Imerese [49]) captured by the Allied player, the Allied player places a Fading Italian Morale event (marked with C for Conditional) into the selection cup. When these events are drawn during a future Admin Phase, the Allied player can immediately place them on the Fading Italian Morale Track on the map, each one increasing the level.



D — Upon capture of a Sicilian port or area of battlefield importance (yielding mutual victory points), a conditional Fading Italian Morale event is placed into the Allied player's selection cup.

E — When a conditional Fading Italian Morale event is drawn, it may be played like any other event (directly in the lowest level slot (from level 1 up to level 3) on the Fading Italian Morale Track on the map). For each one played, negative effects that Italian units face during movement, combat and supply increase. Note that both Catania [26] and Niscemi [18] are critical areas: each contains one of the Sicilian airfields **and** it is an area of battlefield importance. When one of these is captured, the Allied player moves **both** a conditional Air Support asset **and** a conditional Fading Italian Morale event into the Selection Cup. If and when Catania [26] is controlled and undamaged, the Allied player can move yet another conditional Fading Italian Morale event into the Selection Cup! Note that there are only three such events. Further triggering conditions will have no effect after the third event has been placed in the Selection Cup.



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EXAMPLE 11 — STRATEGIC MOVEMENT

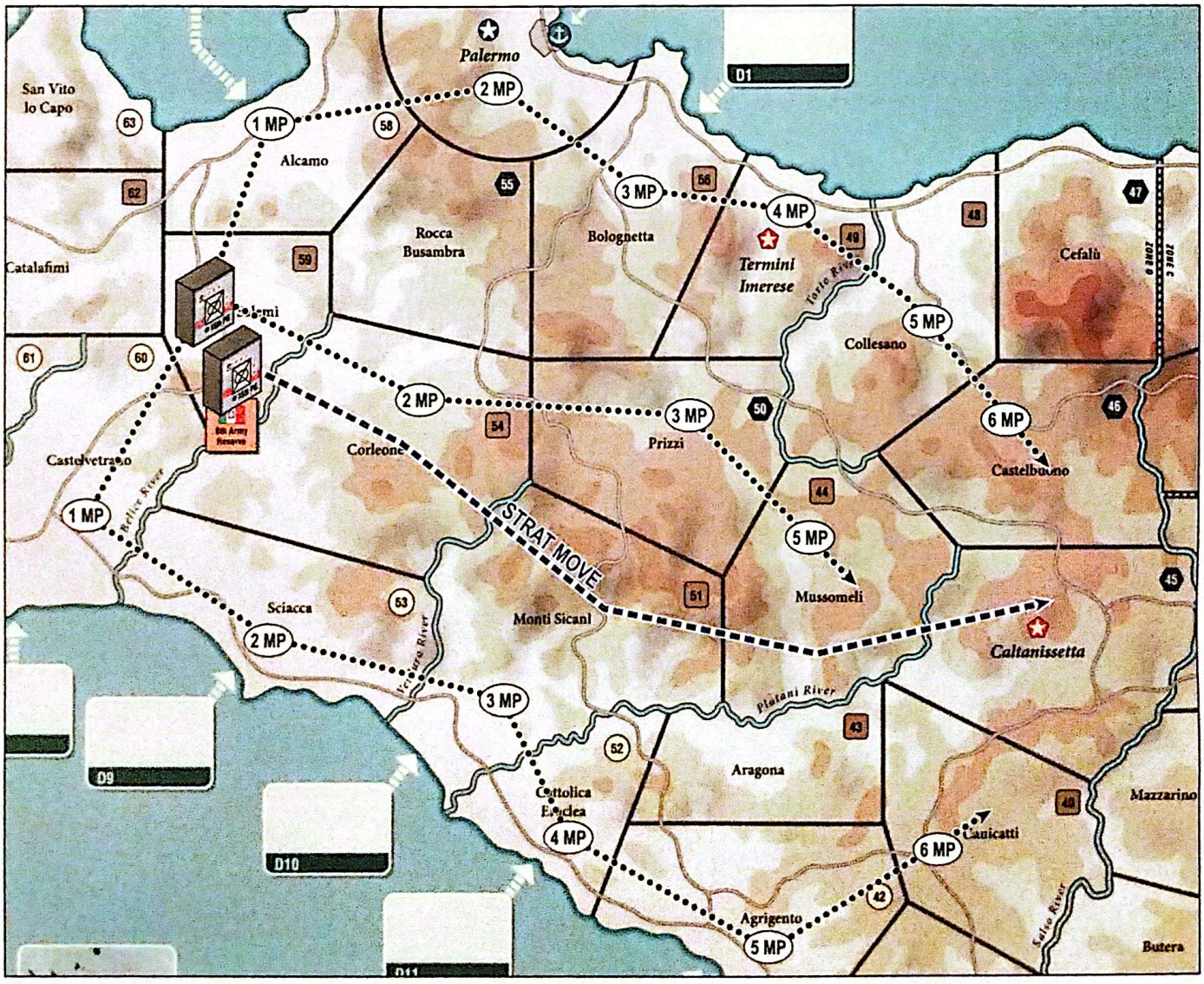
Overview — The Axis player is limited to 1 strategic move per turn. The island, however, is confined and the need for strategic movement may not appear very often. At the beginning of the game, a rapid redeployment of a powerful unit may stave off a calamitous defeat. One of the important locations on the island is Caltanissetta [45], a victory point location. A powerful Axis battle group is deployed just far enough away from this key town that the Axis player will not be able count on getting a unit redeployed from the west all the way into Caltanissetta [45] itself. Three possible movement routes bring the Axis units to all three of the areas bordering the western side of Caltanissetta [45]. Only the strategic movement option will work. Unlike Operational Movement which enables units to move into enemy-controlled areas, Strategic Movement only enables units to move freely within friendly-controlled areas (never crossing a blown bridge nor moving into an area that is enemy-controlled and/or contested). To use this option, the Axis player places one of the 15th PG units in reserve during the Operational Movement Phase. Then, in the Strategic Movement Phase, he moves that reserve unit directly (without MP expenditure) to Caltanissetta [45]. Once moved, the reserve marker is removed to the Reserve Holding Box.

Possible Operational Moves — As a way to compare the value of the strategic move versus the operational move, see how no operational move gets the 15th PG units to Caltanissetta [45]:

- Possible Op Move: from Salemi [59] to Alcamo [58] for 1MP, to Palermo [57] for 1MP, to Bolognetta [56] for 1MP, to Termini Imerese [49] for 1 MP, to Collesano [48] for 1 MP, and finally to Castelbuono [46] for 1 MP and no more MP available.

- Possible Op Move: from Salemi [59] to Corleone [54] for 2MP, to Prizzi [50] for 1MP, and finally to Mussomeli [44] for 2 MP, facing a field connection to reach Caltanissetta [45] without enough MP.

- Possible Op Move: from Salemi [59] to Castelvetrano [60] for 1 MP, to Sciacca [53] for 1MP, to Monti Sicani [51] for 1MP, to Cattolica Eraclea [52] for 1MP, to Agrigento [42] for 1MP, and finally to Canicatti [40] for 1 MP, and no more MP available.



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EXAMPLE 12 — BASIC COMBAT

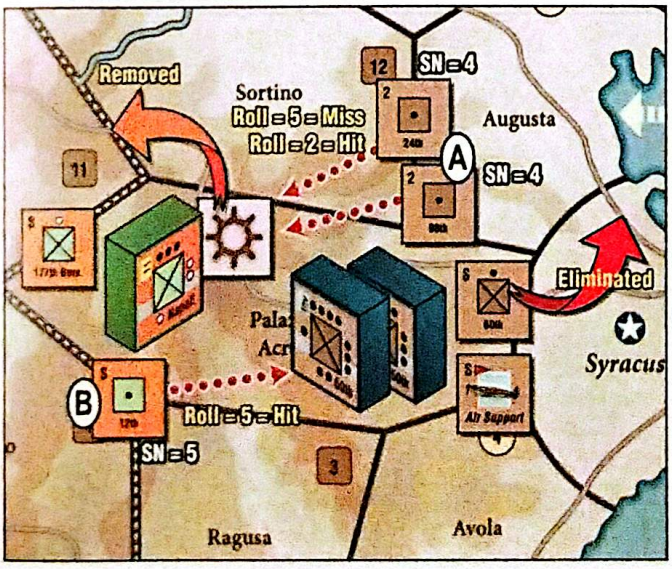
Overview — The Phasing player (the Attacker) determines the order in which combats are resolved in contested areas. Combat is mandatory in a new contested area, but it is optional in a previously contested area — sometimes pinning your opponent is more effective than attacking. When the Phasing player selects a contested area for combat, a single round of combat occurs — defined strictly in 6.2. Avoid the temptation to treat the individual steps in 6.2 as simultaneous; they are not. Note that the hit priorities for the Defender are different than those for the Attacker. Also note that the Hit Priority sequence should be literally followed after **each** of the four firing segments in a combat (if hits were caused): (i) Attacker artillery fire, (ii) Defender artillery fire, (iii) Defender ground fire and (iv) Attacker ground fire.

Battle Asset Limitations — Although players will not usually run into these limits, remember that the Attacker can commit no more than eight battle assets to a combat and that the Defender can commit no more than five battle assets to a combat. In addition, no more than one Italian battle asset can ever be committed to a combat (this limit may be easily forgotten).

A — The Allied player (Attacker) must assign assets to the battle in Palazzolo Acreide [6] first with a battle asset (50th Infantry), two artillery assets (24th and 98th Artillery) and one Air Support asset. The Axis player (Defender) then follows with a battle asset (177th Bersaglieri) and an artillery asset (12th Artillery). Both must simultaneously designate a point unit. The Axis player has no choice (the Napoli Infantry) and the Allied player arbitrarily picks one of the two 50th Infantry division blocks. The attacker fires artillery first.

- **24th and 98th** have –1 (target's point is infantry protected by field works) for a net Success Number (SN) of 5–1=4 and fire with two dice (one for each step of artillery). This is expressed as "2 tries for a 5" — rolls 2, 5 — one hit!

This hit is applied immediately. The first hit priority for the Defender is to remove field works if present (this is the case).



B — Now the defender fires artillery.

- **12th** has no modifiers (target's point not armor nor is it infantry protected by field works) for a net SN of 5 and fires one die. This is "1 try for a 5" — rolls 5 — one hit!

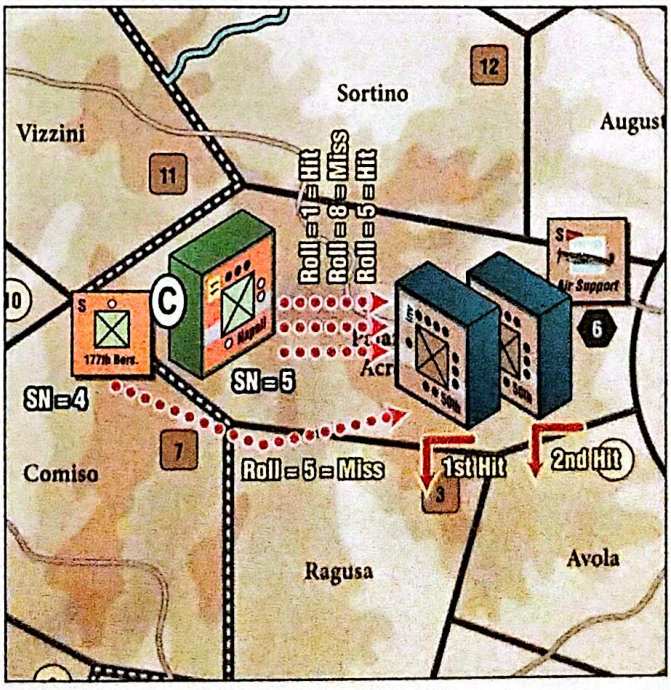
The hit is applied immediately. The first hit priority for the attacker is a mandatory step loss. The Allied player expected this turn of events, which is why he deployed the 50th Infantry asset. Since battle assets can take a step loss, he eliminates the asset to satisfy the artillery hit (placing the 50th Infantry asset into the Eliminated Box).

C — After artillery fire, the artillery assets for both sides are placed in the Used Box. The defender can now conduct ground fire. The firing order is not important.

- **Napoli** has +0 (veteran firing on veteran point unit) for a net SN of 5 and fires with three dice. This is "3 tries for a 5" — rolls 1, 5, 8 — two hits!

- **177th Bers** has –1 (green firing on veteran point unit) for a net SN of 5–1=4 and fires with one die. This is "1 try for a 4" — rolls 5 — no hit!

The Allied player has two hits to resolve and decides to press the attack — perhaps another lucky roll by the Axis player for a third hit would have been enough to cause the Allied player to abort the attack. The Air Support asset is not a battle asset, so it may not be eliminated to absorb one of the hits. The first hit is a mandatory step loss, so one of the 50th Infantry units absorbs the first hit. The Allied player decides not to abort the attack (which would end the combat, disorder both 50th Infantry units, and avoid the second step loss). Therefore the second hit must be applied. Since no unit can take a second hit before all units in the combat take a first hit, the other 50th Infantry unit must take the second hit.



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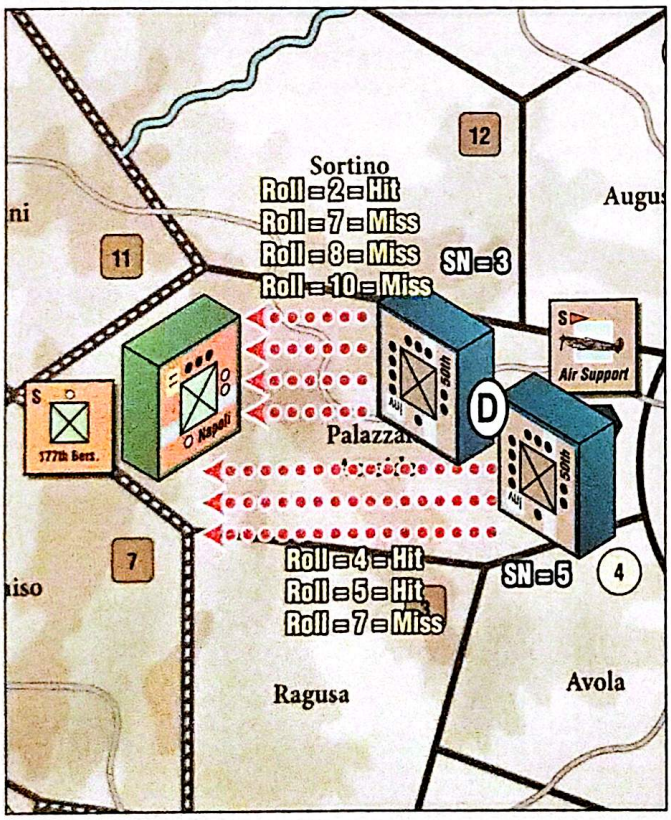
D — Now the Allied player can conduct ground fire. Since the entire division is present (both units have the same color for the divisional stripe), Divisional Integrity applies: one extra die for the unit with the lower SN at time of ground fire. He considers himself lucky that he committed Air Support to the combat, considering how much damage the Axis player has already caused. The Ground Support mission can be used in two ways: (i) as an artillery asset or (ii) as a special battle asset, contributing +2 to the SN of one unit. The Allied player has saved the Air Support asset for the latter use.

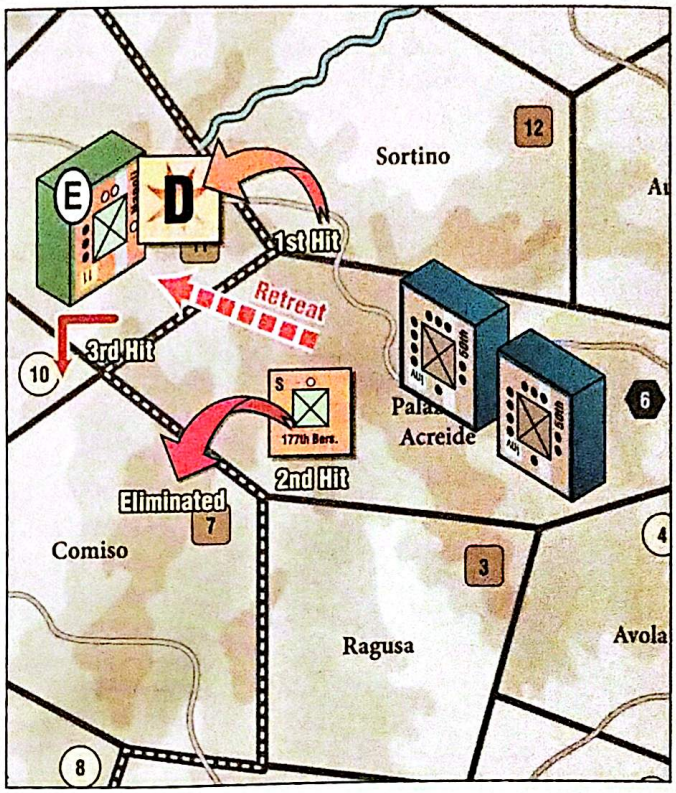
- **Unsupported 50th** has +0 (veteran firing on veteran point unit) and –2 (versus the Defender's Terrain Difficulty Number or TDN) for a net SN of 5–2=3. Divisional Integrity applies to this unit of the division (one extra die added to the three dice for the three steps of strength). This is "4 tries for a 3" — rolls 2, 7, 8, 10 — one hit!

- **Supported 50th** has +0 (veteran firing on veteran point unit), +2 (ground support mission) and –2 (versus TDN of 2) for a net SN of 5. This is "3 tries for a 5" — rolls 4, 5, 7 — two hits!

Without the addition of the Air Support, the Allied attack would have been a dismal failure.



E — The Axis player has three hits to resolve. The first two hit priorities no longer apply (no field works present and hits were not caused by artillery fire). First, he retreats the Napoli Infantry unit to Vizzini [11] resulting in the unit becoming disordered — this absorbs the first hit. There are two remaining hits and they must be applied. He decides to eliminate the 177th Bersaglieri asset (second hit – placing it into the Eliminated Box) and then must finally take a step loss on the Napoli Infantry unit (third hit).



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EXAMPLE 13 — AIRBORNE ASSAULT

Overview — This volume provides three types of assaults compared to the previous volume. The standard type of assault, the river assault, remains unmodified. Two new types of assault, the airborne assault and the beach assault are included with particular rules of use. Note that when any one of the assault conditions applies, the attack is marked with the generic River Assault marker and the River Assault penalty for ground fire applies as well. If more than one type of assault can occur in an area, see 14.27 to determine which type of assault (which combat rules and other conditions) will be used to resolve the combat.

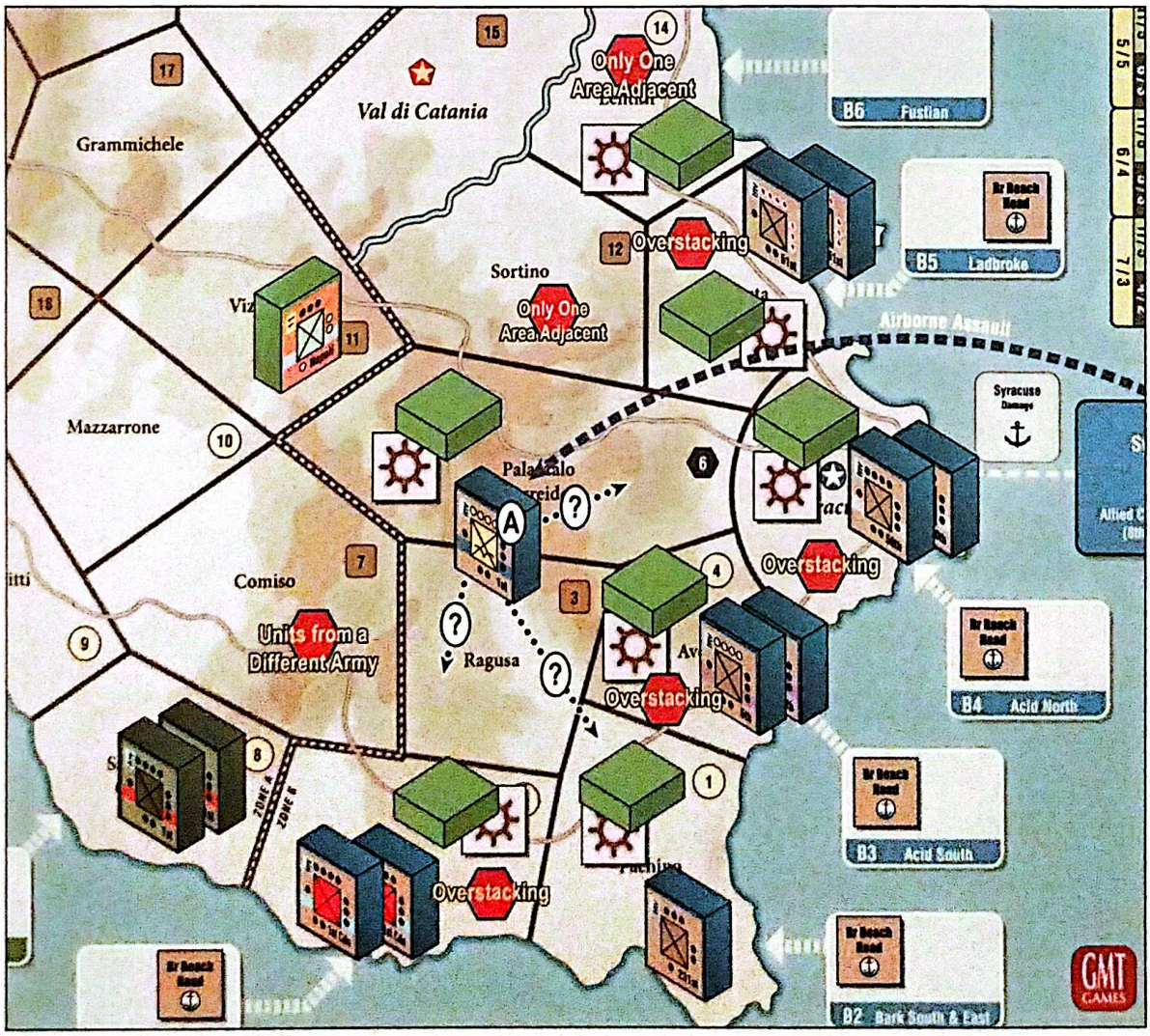
A — Four units — the two US Airborne units and the two British Airbourne units — use the airborne assault rules upon arrival. During the Reinforcement Phase they are placed in the Airborne Assault Box instead of into a beachhead or port box. Then, at the very beginning of combat, before any other combats are conducted, the Allied player conducts an air drop. The air drop rule requires that the airborne unit only be placed in an area that is adjacent to at least two other areas already containing units from the same army. The targeted areas do not have to be empty. They can contain a combination of friendly and/or enemy units. The following areas in the example are legal for the air drop of the 1st British Airbourne unit:

- Palazzolo Acreide [6] – adjacent to British units in Augusta [13], Syracuse [5] and Avola [4]
- Ragusa [3] – adjacent to British units in Avola [4], Pachino [1] and Modica [2]
- Pachino [1] – adjacent to British units in Avola [4] and Modica [2] and allowed to arrive in this area because it does not cause overstacking

The following areas in the example are not legal for the air drop:

- Overstacking – an air drop in Augusta [13], Syracuse [5], Avola [4] and Modica [2] would cause overstacking
- Only One Area Adjacent – an air drop in Sortino [12] or Lentini [14] is not allowed
- Units from a Different Army – although Comiso [7] is adjacent to two areas with Allied units, the units in Santa Croce Camerina [8] are US units (not in the same army)

If an air drop occurs in an area with an enemy unit, the combat in that area must be immediately resolved before combat in any other area takes place. The drop is dangerous—no hits can be avoided.



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EXAMPLE 14 — BEACH ASSAULT

Overview — The invasion primarily involves beach assaults during Game Turn 1. What follows is typical for the combats once landings are complete. The Axis player should expect that coastal garrisons placed forward into the coastal areas are likely to be mostly eliminated. Judicious placement of some garrisons in depth and possibly ignoring some areas on the coast may proof useful for a stronger defense (at the cost of allowing the Allied player an easier landing). The Allied player should expect to get the most out of his Naval Support since its best value is on the coast. Another valuable invasion capability comes in the form of Rangers and Commandos—useful but precious as well. Once landing (in the Operational Movement Phase) is complete, the players conduct the Combat Phase. Except for any airborne assaults (performed first), the Phasing player chooses the order in which the other combats and conducted. During Game Turn 1, all such combats are beach assaults (where the Axis player has chosen to defend on the coast in front of the selected beachheads).

Note on Combat Order — In the process of resolving a combat, one area is selected by the Attacker, then assets are placed (Attacker first), point units are selected (Defender first) and finally units are revealed. The two combats depicted in this example are completely resolved one at a time (not in parallel as narrated below)—it is only a convenience that this example treats them simultaneously.

A — In Licata [20], after assets have been allocated, point units selected and units revealed, the previously unrevealed Italian Untried unit is revealed (it was placed face down in Licata [20] during set up, drawn from a randomly shuffled pile of similarly unrevealed Italian coastal garrison units). The unit turns out to the one of the typical low-strength green units. Before any fire resolution occurs, the unit must face a morale check—if it succeeds, it will remain in good order, if it fails, it will become disordered before the first shot is fired!

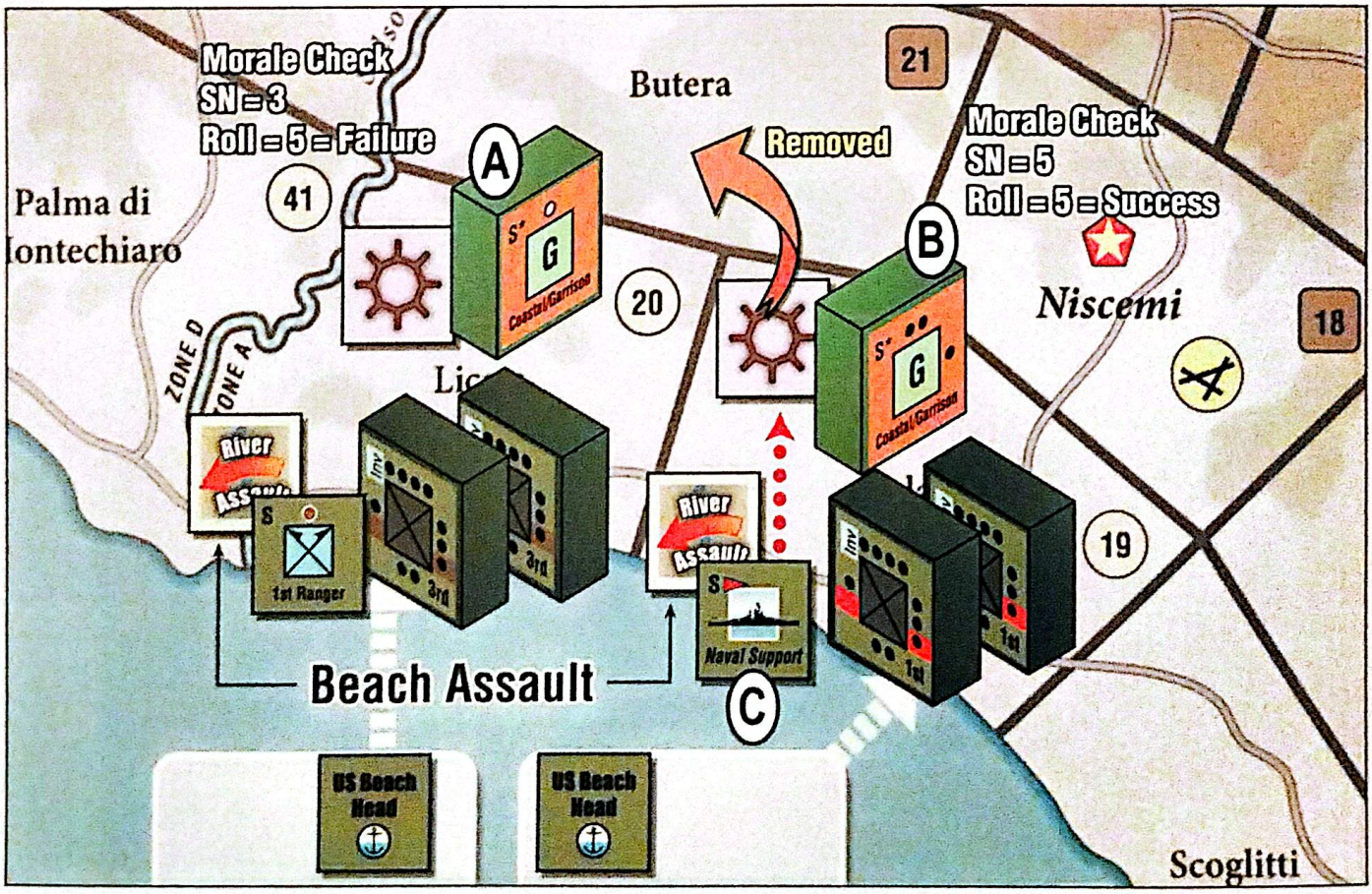
- **Coastal Garrison** in Licata [20] has a –2 (green unit) for a net Success Number (SN) of 5–2=3 and conducts a morale check with one die (for the unit). This is expressed as "I try for a 3" — rolls 5 — failure!

The unit is marked with a disordered marker (note that its field works remains unaffected).

B — In Gela [19] (following the narrative through the other combat), the previously unrevealed Untried Italian unit is revealed and turns out to be the best coastal garrison unit in the game (a veteran unit with strength 2). Before any fire resolution occurs, the unit must face a morale check.

- **Coastal Garrison** in Gela [19] has a +0 (veteran unit) for a net Success Number (SN) of 5 and conducts a morale check with one die (for the unit). This is expressed as "I try for a 5" — rolls 5 — success!

The Axis player is pleased because this unit has a chance to hurt the Allied units it faces.



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C — In both combat locations, it is now time for artillery fire. Neither player committed artillery assets, except that the Naval Support asset can function as artillery if more than one of them was committed. In Gela [19], the one Naval Support asset by itself is used to immediately remove the field works in the area. Consider this as a sustained pre-invasion bombardment. If the Allied player had committed two Naval Support assets to this one combat, the first asset would remove the field works, and then the second asset would operate as an artillery asset. Now past the artillery fire steps in the combat procedure, it is time for ground fire. We'll examine ground fire by the Defender in both locations first, followed by ground fire by the Attacker in both locations last.

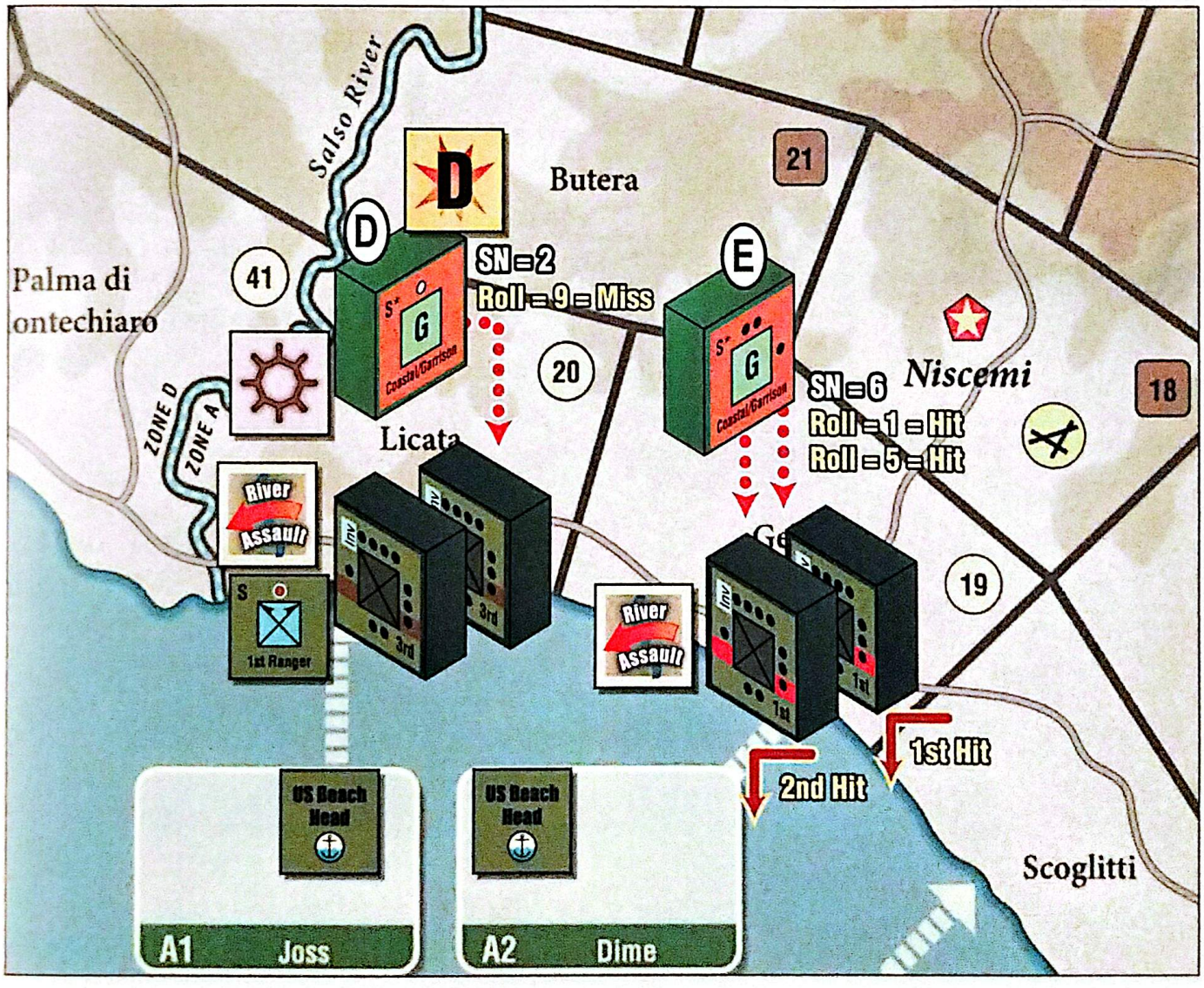
D — In Licata [20], the Defender conducts ground fire. Since the unit is still a green Untried Italian unit, it gains no positive SN modifiers—it must survive combat to become a Tried unit to gain the benefit of any such SN modifiers.

- **Coastal Garrison** in Licata [20] has a –2 (green unit) and a –1 (disordered) and does not gain the river assault bonus (+1 for targeting unit(s) marked with a river assault) for a net Success Number (SN) of 5–3=2 and fires with one die. This is expressed as "1 try for a 2" — rolls 9 — miss!

E — In Gela [19], the Defender conducts ground fire. This veteran unit is able to gain the benefit of positive SN modifiers.

- **Coastal Garrison** in Gela [19] has a +0 (veteran unit) and it gains the river assault bonus (+1 for targeting unit(s) marked with a river assault) for a net Success Number (SN) of 6 and fires with two dice. This is expressed as "2 tries for a 6" – rolls 1, 5 – success!

The string of luck continues with the strong coastal garrison facing the invasion at Gela. The Allied player has two hits to resolve on the 1st Infantry units. He might (when faced with such luck) choose to abort the attack, but because this is a beach assault, aborting the attack will immediately place the units into the At Sea holding box (using Sea Retreat). Worse than that, by retreating from the coastal area, the coastal area and the (now empty) beachhead become Axis-controlled. This permanently destroys that beachhead! In this disastrous case, the beachhead marker is placed on the Eliminated Large Units track, counting as victory points (VP) for the Axis player at game end. It is therefore out of the question for the Allied player to abort the attack. Both hits must be absorbed, one per unit.



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F — In Licata [20], the Attacker conducts ground fire. The Allied force will benefit in many ways: (i) Divisional Integrity (plus one die), (ii) Elite Ranger asset, (iii) Disordered, Untried Italian unit (not able to take advantage of any positive SN).

- **First 3rd Infantry** has +1 (veteran firing on a green point unit) and +0 for the Defender's TDN for a net SN of 5+1=6. Divisional Integrity applies to this unit of the division (one extra die added to the four dice for the four steps of strength). This is "5 tries for a 6" — rolls 2, 4, 5, 9, 10 — three hits!

- **Second 3rd Infantry** has +1 (veteran firing on a green point unit) and +0 for the Defender's TDN for a net SN of 5+1=6. This is "4 tries for a 6" — rolls 1, 6, 8, 9 — two hits!

- **1st Ranger** has +2 (elite firing on a green point unit) and +0 for the Defender's TDN for a net SN of 5+2=7. This is "1 try for a 7" — rolls 5 — one hit!

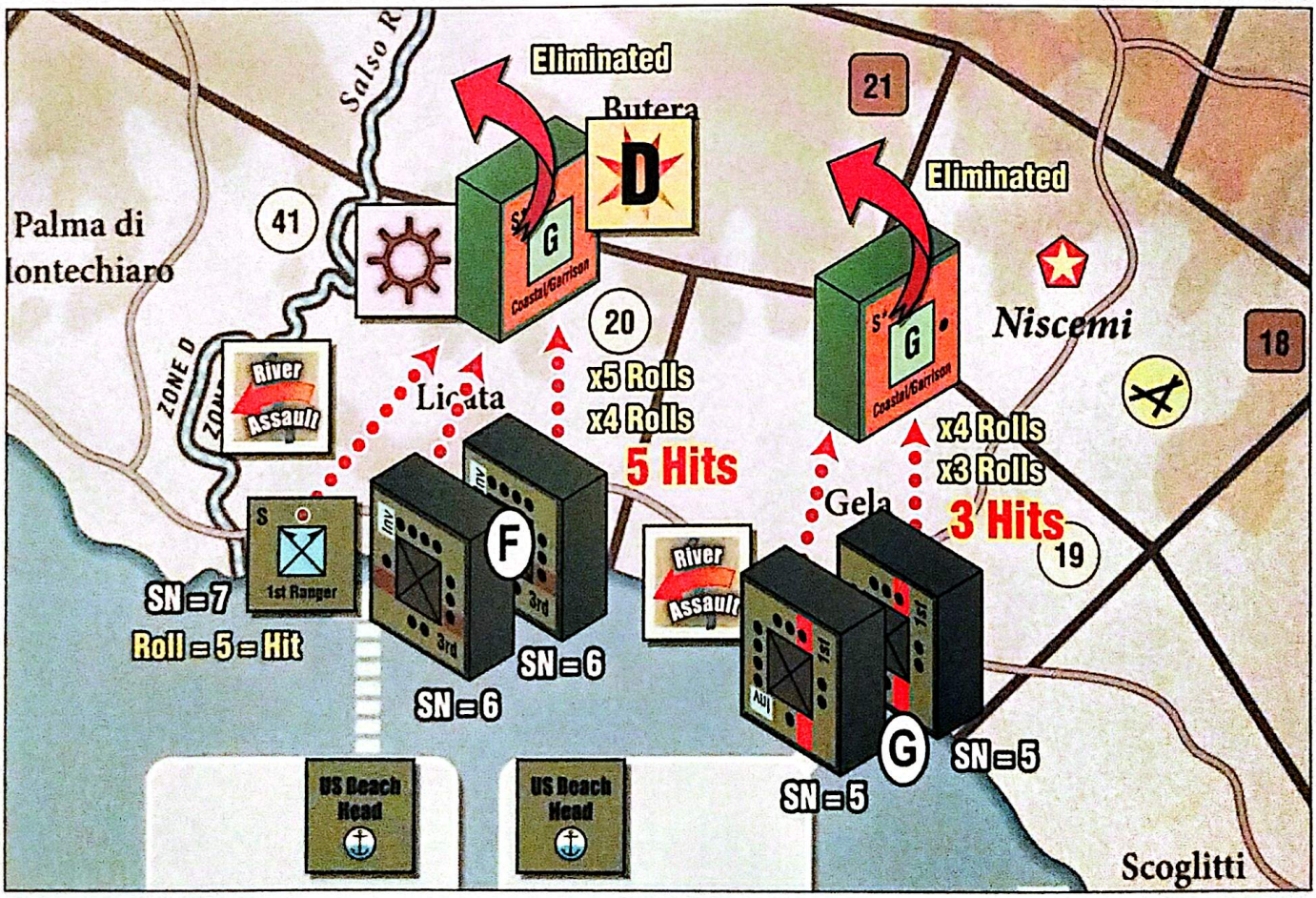
The Untried Italian coastal garrison unit uses the field works to absorb the first hit and it can retreat out of Licata [20] into Butera [21] to absorb another hit but the third of the six hits eliminates the unit (it is placed in the Eliminated Box). Since the 3rd Infantry unit is not armor class, it cannot achieve an exploitation of this success (exploitations are not awarded for assaults in any event).

G — In Gela [19], the Attacker conducts ground fire. The 1st Infantry force will have a hard time knocking out the strong coastal garrison.

- **First 1st Infantry** has +0 (veteran firing on a veteran point unit) and +0 for the Defender's TDN for a net SN of 5. Divisional Integrity applies to this unit of the division (one extra die added to the three dice for the three steps of strength). This is "4 tries for a 5" — rolls 2, 4, 6, 9 — two hits!

- **Second 1st Infantry** has +0 (veteran firing on a veteran point unit) and +0 for the Defender's TDN for a net SN of 5. This is "3 tries for a 5" — rolls 5, 8, 9 — one hit!

The coastal garrison unit has to absorb three hits. The first hit can be absorbed by retreating into Niscemi [18] and becoming disordered, but the second and third hits must be absorbed as step losses and it is eliminated. The 1st Infantry division just barely gets the job done. If the Allied player had not assigned Naval Support to this battle, the field works marker could have helped the unit to survive (not a good thing for the Allied timeline).



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EXAMPLE 15 — FLANKING INVASION

Overview — There are three counters in the game, two US 30th RCT (–) counters and one British 3rd CDO counter, that have multiple functions (and the counter markers reflect both an "asset" style of layout and an "event" style of layout). Although they can be used purely as battle assets, they can also be used as special independent attacking assets — as the flanking invasion — which is an event. This allows the Allied player to leapfrog an area along the coast and potentially surround an Axis unit that is stubbornly defending the coast. Since we have covered the Combat Phase in a lot of detail, this example will leave out some of the normally occurring strict narrative to emphasize the key aspects of the flanking invasion.

A — During the Admin Phase, the Allied player sees the opportunity to bypass the Italian Aosta Infantry unit in Santo Stefano di Camastra [36] by launching a flanking invasion from Cefalù [47] into Sant' Agata di Militello [34]. This is considered an assault (so it marked with the River Assault marker and suffers the River Assault penalties in combat). The flanking invasion is immediately resolved (there is no waiting for the Operational Movement Phase or the Combat Phase). Nevertheless the strict procedure of the Combat Phase is followed to resolve it. Note Allied player can only commit Air Support and/or Naval Support assets to the battle.

B — When the Air Support asset is committed to the Ground Support mission, it can be used either as an artillery asset or as a battle asset. After assets are assigned (two by the Allied player, none by the Axis player) and point units are declared and revealed, the Allied player conducts artillery fire (again — as if it were the Combat Phase). In this case, the Allied player chooses to use one of his Air Support assets as an artillery asset.

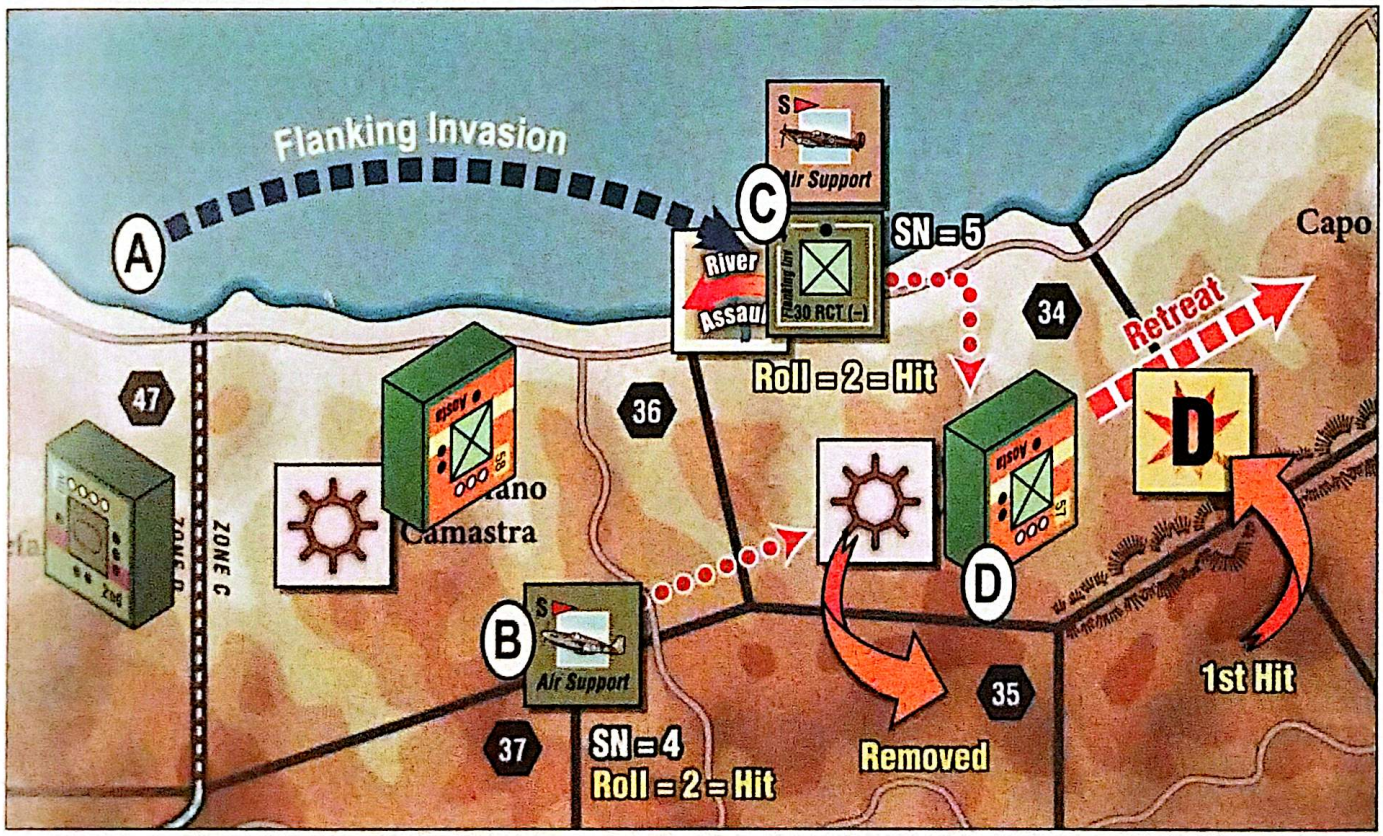
- **Air Support** firing as artillery has –1 (target point unit is infantry class protected by field works) for a net SN of 5–1=4. This is "1 try for a 4" — rolls 2 — Hit!

The first hit priority for the Defender is to absorb a hit by eliminating the field works. The Axis player removes the field works marker.

C — Now we skip ahead to ground fire conducted by the Attacker (the Axis player did not assign an artillery asset to this battle and the example assumes that ground fire by the Defender was ineffective). The Allied player uses the second Air Support asset as a battle asset in support of the Flanking Invasion asset.

Flanking Invasion has +0 (veteran asset firing on veteran point unit), –2 (Defender's TDN) and +2 (Air Support as a supporting battle asset) for a net SN of 5. This is "1 try for a 5" — rolls 5 — Hit!.

D — The defending Italian Aosta Infantry must absorb yet another hit, and it does so by retreating from Sant' Agata di Militello [34] into Capo di Orlando [31] and becoming disordered. Since the Flanking Invasion has survived this round of combat, it remains in the area. It cannot initiate an attack, it may only defend. Note that although the Italian Aosta Infantry in Santo Stefano di Camastra [36] cannot retreat into this area, its supply line is not blocked by the presence of the Flanking Invasion.



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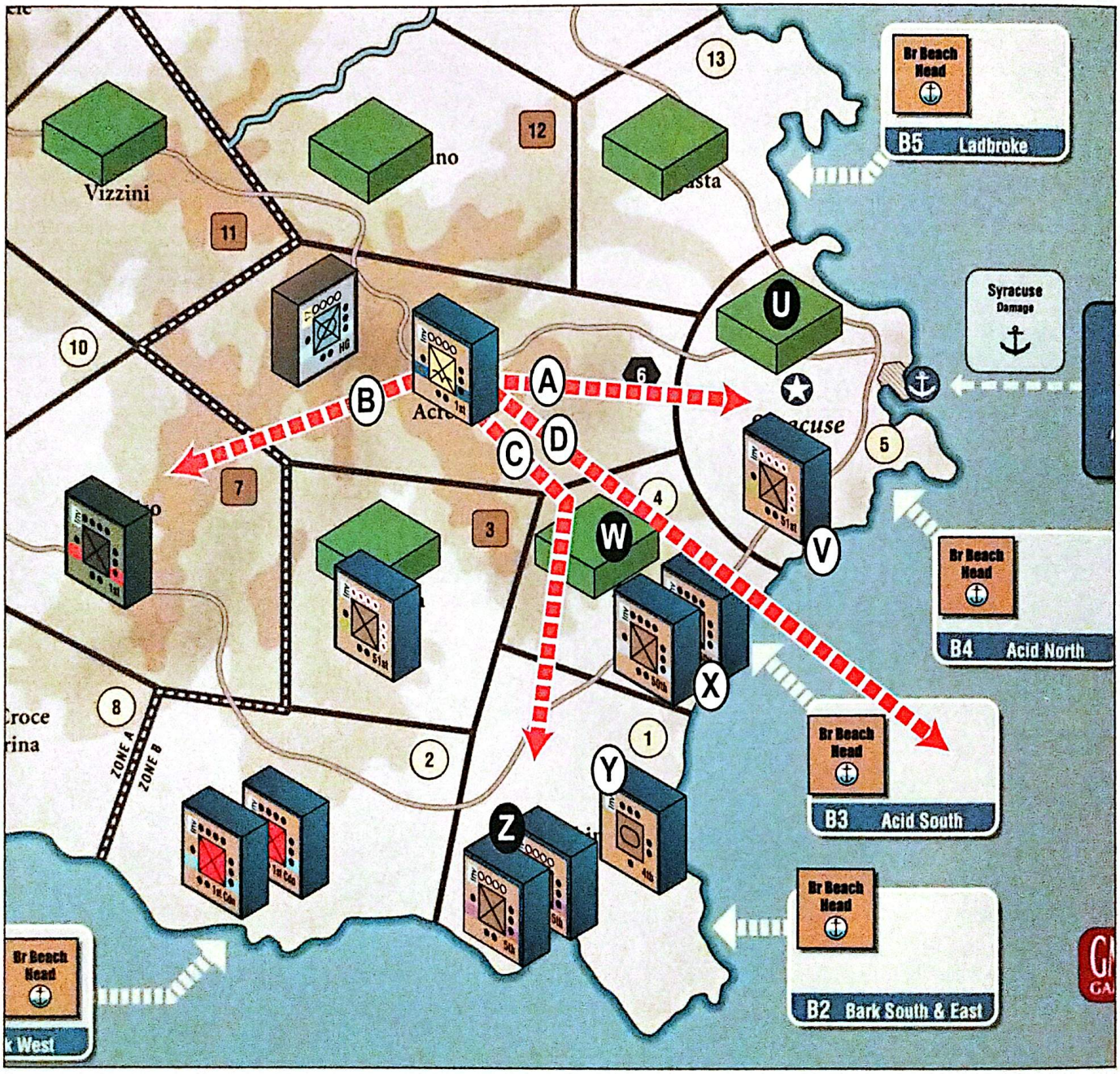
EXAMPLE 16 — RETREAT

Overview — Retreats have been only briefly covered in the previous examples. At times, invasion congestion will cause units to move back more than one area and even back off the island. There is a hierarchy of choices that is, what to try first, then next, and so on. First a unit moves back to an area with zero to one friendly units; failing that, back to an area with two friendly units and then repeatedly back until reaching an area with zero to one friendly units; failing that, staying inside the unit's army zone but moving out to sea through a valid beachhead; failing that, moving across a restricted or prohibited army boundary (and retreating per the above hierarchy from the top); failing that, remaining in position and losing steps, even to the point of elimination.

Retreat Options — The examples will step through these choices in more detail using the British 1st Airbourne unit (in Palazzolo Acreide [6]) being required to retreat from a combat that is not depicted. In addition, this unit has not yet been released from its original army boundary restrictions (it must operate in Zone B). With the exception of the combat area in question, Axis forces are represented by a single unrevealed block in each area — it does not matter what they are, just that the areas are contested from the Allied player point of view. The forces in Syracuse [5], Avola [4] and Pachino [1] are variable depending on the retreat situation below. For example, if an example states that force U is in Syracuse [5], then assume that force V is not present in that area.



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A — Assume that in Syracuse [5], sample force V is present and that in Avola [4], sample force X is present. The British 1st Airbourne unit (hereafter the "retreating unit") has only one retreat option available:

- Retreat into an enemy-occupied area is forbidden.
- Retreat directly into a friendly-controlled area with zero or one unit is the most preferred retreat path. This is why the retreating unit cannot directly retreat to Avola [4].
- Although Comiso [7] is an option that an aggressive Allied player might like to use, retreating across a restricted or prohibited army boundary is the very last retreat path allowed (short of holding position and losing steps).

B — Now assume that in Syracuse [5], force U is present and that in Avola [4] both forces W and X are present (causing the area to be contested). The retreating unit has only one retreat option available again.

- Retreat into an enemy-occupied area is forbidden.
- As the very last retreat option, the retreating unit is now forced across the restricted boundary (despite not yet being released) into Zone A into Comiso [7] occupied by the US 1st Infantry unit.
- If both units of the US 1st Infantry were in Comiso [7] (given this retreat pathway), then the retreating unit would have to continue to retreat out of Comiso [7] to another available area, in this case Santa Croce Camerina [8].
- Since the retreating unit has now violated a restricted army boundary, the Allied player may now release (flip the marker for it in the 8th Army Boundary Restrictions Box) the unit so that it may continue to operate in Zone A. This has the added benefit that this unit can receive not only any Allied strategic assets and events, but it may also receive the support of the British 1st Airbourne asset (since it is considered released for use in Zone A as well). Note that when non-strategic army assets are released in this manner, they still must be used in support of units in their own army.

C — Now assume that in Syracuse [5], both forces U and V present (causing the area to be contested), that in Avola [4] force X is present and that in Pachino [1], force Y is present. The retreating unit now faces a longer retreat path with possibly a number of choices.

- The retreating unit has a retreat option that allows it to remain within its own army zone, namely by retreating from Syracuse [5] into Avola [4].
- However, Avola [4] is currently occupied by two Allied units, so the retreating unit cannot remain in this area.
- The primary retreat priority is to find an area, within its own army zone that has zero or one unit in it. The retreating unit, instead of going out to sea via sea retreat, can continue retreating from Avola [4] back to Pachino [1], where only one Allied unit is located. This is a valid and complete retreat path (and the only one available per the rules).
- If Pachino [1] also was occupied by two Allied units, but Modica [2] was only occupied by one unit, the retreating unit would retreat from Avola [4], to Pachino [1] and then to Modica [2].
- The intent of the retreat rules is — if possible — to (i) move retreating units to the nearest non-overstacked friendly area and (ii) keep them in their authorized army zones, even if this means using sea retreat.

D — Finally, assume that in Syracuse [5], both forces U and V present (causing the area to be contested), that in Avola [4] force X is present and that in Pachino [1], force Z is present. This is a situation that could happen early during an invasion where the Allied player has not developed any backfield area for retreating units.

- The retreating unit has a retreat option that allows it to remain within its own army zone, namely by retreating from Syracuse [5] into Avola [4].
- However, the Allied player sees that there is no existing pathway for the retreating unit to reach an area occupied only by zero or one friendly unit, and still remain with the current army zone (because both Pachino [1] and Modica [2] are occupied by two British units each).
- The retreating unit in Avola [4] therefore has no other choice but to use sea retreat from the Acid South beachhead [B3]. This means that the retreating unit is moved out through the beachhead to the At Sea Holding Box. The only way back to land is during the next Allied player Operational Movement Phase, using the landing procedure.

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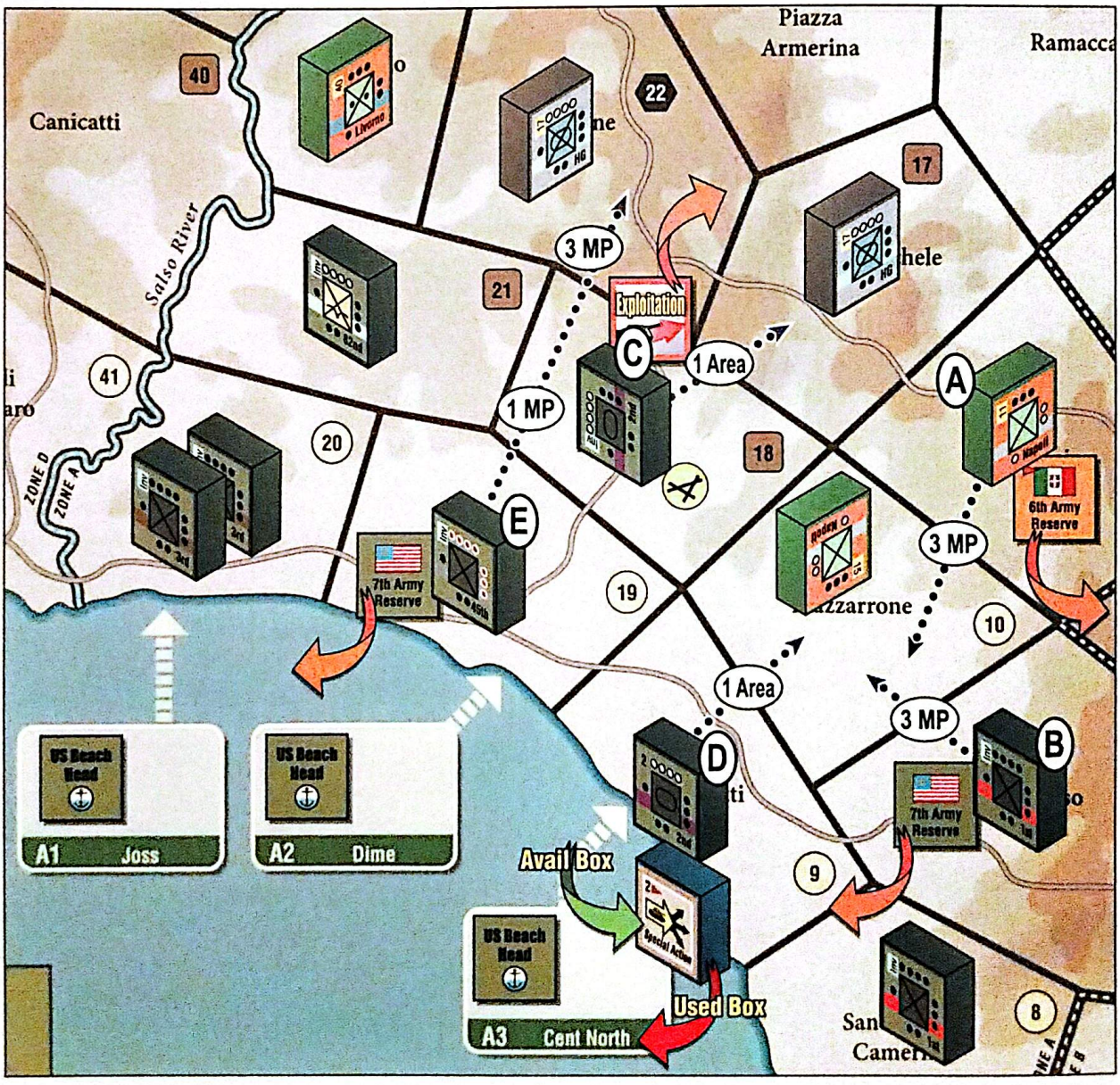
EXAMPLE 17 — REACTION & BREAKTHROUGH

Overview — After all combats have been resolved, the Non-phasing player has the opportunity to move units marked with a reserve marker in reaction to what the Phasing player has accomplished so far. He may not move his units into an uncontested enemy area and cause combat. The opportunity for the Phasing player to move units in the Breakthrough Movement Phase is limited to the following conditions: the player may move units (i) marked with an exploitation marker, (ii) marked with a reserve marker or (iii) by expending a Special Action. If this movement causes an area to be contested, the combat in this area is mandatory. A round of Breakthrough Combat (which is otherwise just like regular Combat) must occur due to Breakthrough Movement and it may occur if the Phasing player plays a Special Action in an already contested area. For the examples below, none of the combat rounds of the Breakthrough Combat Phase will be illustrated.

A — After the normal Combat Phase is complete, the Breakthrough Phases are conducted. The non-Phasing player has the opportunity to react (with units marked with a reserve marker) to the potential points of breakthrough prior to the Breakthrough Movement Phase. The Axis player had previously marked the Italian Napoli Infantry in Vizzini [11] with the 6th Army Reserve marker (during an Axis Operational Movement Phase). Given the developing situation, the Axis player decides to reinforce Mazzarrone [10] with the Italian Napoli Infantry in Vizzini [11], trying to prevent the destruction of a large unit (the loss of the single-strength infantry unit will yield an Allied VP). A reacting unit (marked in reserve) may make a full operational move during the Reaction Phase, including entering into a contested area, but may not create a newly contested area.

B — Now the Allied player begins the Breakthrough Movement Phase. There are two ways to move during this phase: (i) units marked in reserve may make a full operational move and (ii) armor units marked with an exploitation marker or subject to the play of a Special Action may move one area (as exploitation units). In both cases, the Phasing player may create newly contested areas. Given the Axis choice to reinforce Mazzarrone



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[10] during the Reaction Phase, the Allied player decides to move a unit into that area to protect the flank of the breakthrough. He moves the US 1st Infantry marked in reserve in Comiso [7] into Mazzarrone [10], with an expectation of securing the elimination of one of the Axis units or better. The 7th Army reserve marker is removed.

C — The Allied player now conducts some congestion management in order to prepare for additional attacks on the Axis line. The US 2nd Armor in Niscemi [18] was marked with an exploitation marker from a successful combat (in the just preceding Combat Phase) in which the Axis unit in the area was eliminated by at least one more step loss than necessary. The Allied player moves the US 2nd Armor from Niscemi [18] into Grammichele [17] to create a newly contested area.

D — The Allied player decides to use the Reusable Special Action (placing the block into the Used Box) to advance the US 2nd Armor unit in Scoglitti [9] one area forward into Mazzarrone [10] to pressure a weak part of the Axis position. Note that if this unit had been marked in reserve, it could have made a dramatic operational movement into either Grammichele [17] or Caltagirone [22].

E — Finally the Allied player decides to move the US 45th Infantry marked in reserve in Gela [19] forward to Niscemi [18] costing 1 MP (road connection) and then on to Caltagirone [22] costing 2 MP (1 MP for the road connection and +1 MP for entering an occupied area). The 7th Army reserve marker is removed. Note that limits on reserve units apply only to Strategic Movement — both moves with the reserve units were operational moves.

EXAMPLE 18 — SUPPLY

Overview — The Supply Phase affects players during their own player turn, so it is important to take actions that leave your units supplied during your own Supply Phase. The worst effects do not immediately take hold, however, which allows players to consider bolder moves. Note that the units in this example are placed to show aspects of the three supply path tracing sub-cases in the supply rules. Also assume that the Allied supply line traces out of the image to the southern coast road and then to the Allied beachhead in the Joss [A1] landing box (as the valid supply source).

A — The US 2nd Armor unit in Aragona [43] traces directly through friendly-controlled areas to the valid supply source (Joss [A1]).

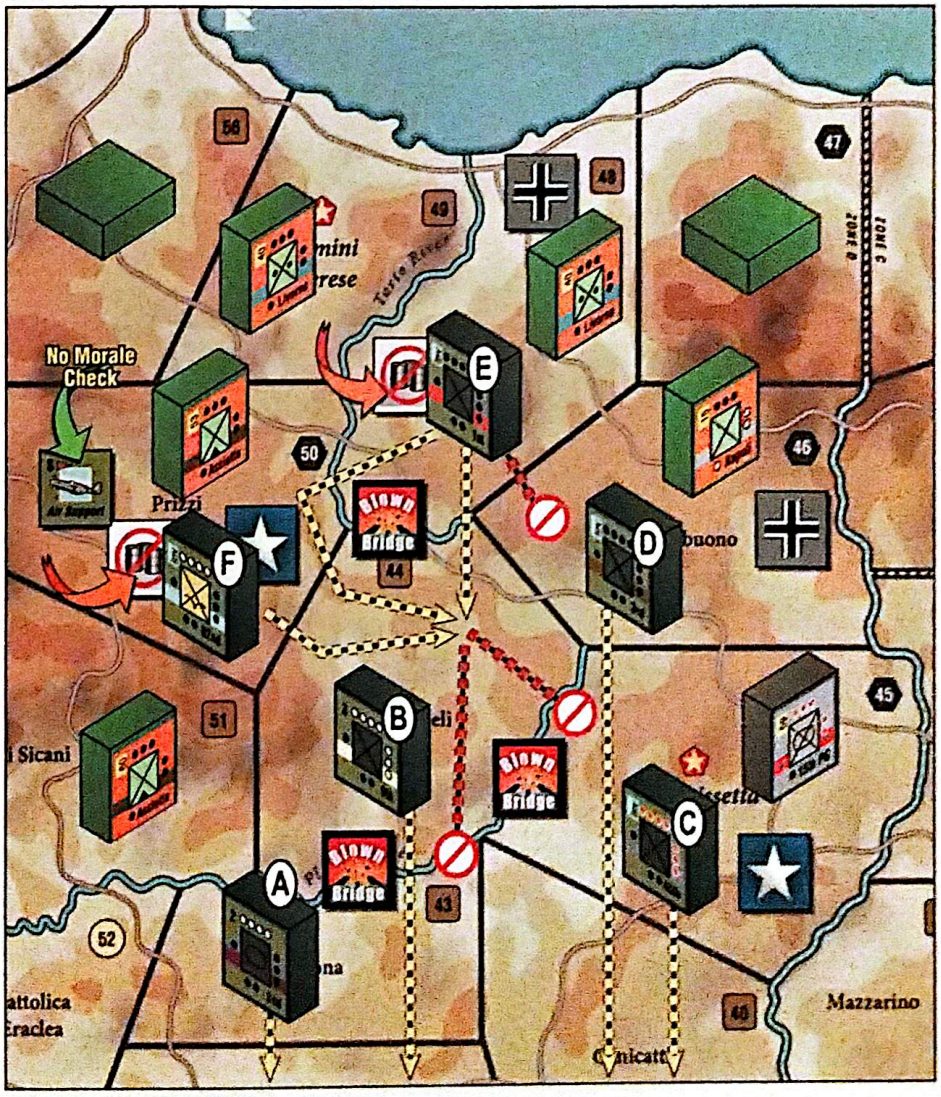
- Uses **9.31a** – from a friendly unit to a valid supply source.

B — The US 9th Infantry unit in Mussomeli [44] traces from across the blown bridge to Aragona [43] and onward through friendly-controlled areas to the valid supply source.

- Uses **9.31a** – from a friendly unit to a valid supply source, tracing across a blown bridge when starting adjacent to that blown bridge.

C — The US 45th Infantry unit in Caltanissetta [45] traces out of the contested area to Canicatti [40] and onward through friendly-controlled areas to the valid supply source.

- Uses **9.31c** – out of an occupied friendly-controlled area (including enemy units)
- Uses **9.31a** – from a friendly unit to a valid supply source.



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D — The US 3rd Infantry unit in Castelbuono [46] does have a successful supply path and it needs all three sub-cases of rule 9.31. The key for saving the unit is that Caltanisetta [45], while contested, is under Allied control. Note that a supply path operates more liberally than a movement path — the US 3rd Infantry unit could not move directly from one enemy-occupied area to another, but the supply path can do this (given Allied control at the right place in the path).

- Uses **9.31b** – out of an enemy-controlled area
- Uses **9.31c** – into, through **and** out of an occupied friendly-controlled area (including enemy units)
- Uses **9.31a** – from a friendly unit to a valid supply source.

E — The case for the US 1st Infantry in Collesano [48] does not look good. There are multiple reasons why this unit must be marked as unsupplied.

- The path to Castelbuono [46] is blocked because the area is enemy-controlled (so the restriction in 9.31b comes into play – the path cannot be traced into or through the area).
- The path to Mussomeli [44] is valid for entry into the area because (i) 9.31b allows the unit to trace out of Collesano [48] and (ii) 9.31a allows the unit to start adjacent to a blown bridge and (iii) 9.31c allows the unit to trace into, through and out of a friendly-controlled area. But then there are only two supply tracing options and they are both blocked by blown bridges. The restriction of 9.31a — the path may only trace across a blown bridge if the tracing unit starts adjacent to a blown bridge — comes into play. Neither of these blown bridge crossings can be made.
- The path to Prizzi [50] is valid for similar reasons because (i) 9.31b allows the unit to trace out of Collesano [48] and (ii) 9.31c allows the unit to trace into, through and out of a friendly-controlled area. But the supply path fails at this point for similar reasons given the two blown bridges.

F — The case for the 82nd Airborne unit in Prizzi [50] also does not look good. While it may trace out of Prizzi [50] (due to 9.31c), the supply path stops in Mussomeli [44] due to the two blown bridges. Thus, it too must be marked as unsupplied. The Allied player decides to protect this unit by playing an available Air Support asset using the Air Supply mission. Although the unit must remain unsupplied, the Allied player does not have to conduct a morale check for an unsupplied unit. Failure of the morale check would make the unit become disordered, making its position more tenuous in combat.

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